



REDUCING RTO: GETTING MORE ORDERS DELIVERED



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UNDERSTANDING RTO AT MEESHO

WHY PARCELS COME BACK



ONE METRIC, TWO VERY DIFFERENT PROBLEMS

Return to Origin

A shipped parcel that can't be delivered to the buyer, and travels all the way back to the seller's warehouse

RTO is not a customer return

- A return comes back after delivery; an RTO is never successfully delivered
- Meesho pays for shipping both ways: about 1 in 6 orders

Buyer constrained Refusals and no-shows

Demand side disinterest

Refused at the door

Lost interest in the parcel

Bought it elsewhere meanwhile

Nobody there to receive it

Not home in the delivery window

Unreachable by phone

Network constrained Failures and damage

Network inefficiencies

Attempt failed or never made

Fake "attempted" marked

Address not found

Wrong, damaged or mis-sent

Damaged or wrong item

Mis-sorted or routed far

RTO IN NUMBERS (Q4 FY26, ANNUALISED)

17%
of shipped orders never reach the buyer: COD 20%, prepaid 5%

39.0 Cr
parcels a year travel back to sellers; 94% were COD

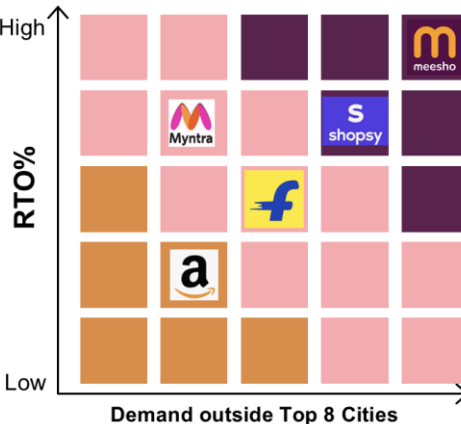
₹121
Meesho's cost per RTO: 2 network trips + 3 door attempts

₹4,720 Cr
lost a year, 10.2% of Meesho's net sales (NMV)

₹16.5
of RTO cost carried by every order placed, delivered or not

₹50
spent getting a parcel to the door before the buyer can refuse

DEMAND OUTSIDE TOP CITIES DRIVES MEESHO'S RTO RATES



Widest reach, highest RTO

88% of Meesho's 264 Mn users buy from outside the top 8 cities

Cash-on-delivery dominates where trust is low

Buyers sit far from the nearest last-mile hub

Delivery takes longer to remote areas

COD orders fail at **20%**, prepaid at 5%

Failure climbs from **15%** at 2 km to **22%** past 10 km

RTO rises from **22%** at 1–2 days to **35%** past 5 days

Roughly 17% of everything Meesho ships never reaches the buyer

WHO PAYS FOR AN RTO

Customer

- **Waits days** for a retry
- **No flexibility** in order time or address
- **Waits 4–5 days** for every new order
- **51.6%** saw "attempted" when nobody came

Delivery agent

- **Loses time** for addresses with only landmarks
- **Up to 3 trips** for one parcel
- **Same pay** for a failed 12 km drop
- **3+ failed drops a day**, agents told us

Seller

- **Capital locked** for ~3 weeks
- **Stock comes back** damaged or missing
- **Sees the count**, never the reason
- **Repacks and relists** every return

Meesho

- **₹50 spent** before the outcome is known
- **No shipping income** without delivery
- **₹42 more** on two repeat attempts
- **₹29 more** to ship it back

Prevent refusals where we can, and resell the rest nearby

Buyer side: make paying online the better deal at checkout · **Network side:** every attempt needs proof · **Still refused:** sell it in the same pincode instead of shipping it back

= ₹121 lost on every RTO parcel, ₹4,720 Cr a year, and nobody gets anything for it.
The buyer waits, the rider wastes trips, the seller's money is stuck for ~3 weeks, and Meesho pays both ways.

HOW STAKEHOLDERS ARE AFFECTED

CASE PERSONAS AND PRIMARY RESEARCH

ASSOCIATED STAKEHOLDER PERSONAS

 HARSHITA (CUSTOMER) <i>Usually not at home, 25-year-old IT employee</i> • Out 9–6, exactly when riders deliver • COD means nobody else can accept it • Phone on silent; ignores unknown calls • Can't pick a slot or redirect once shipped	 KESHAV (CUSTOMER) <i>Refused at door, 21, student, loves trends</i> • Orders on impulse, barely thinking about it • COD means he never really committed • Parcel arrives five days later; the want is gone • Nothing in between asked him to confirm	 ARCHIT (DELIVERY AGENT) <i>No attempt made, 25 orders a day</i> • Paid the same whether the drop is 2 km or 12 km • 3 calls to find addresses with only landmarks • Hub is often far from the delivery location • Marking "attempted" costs him nothing	 SARA (SELLER) <i>Bears the brunt, entrepreneur, sells online</i> • No revenue and no line item explaining the loss • Capital locked for the full round trip • Panel shows the RTO count, never the reason • Nothing to do but wait for the parcel to return
ATTRIBUTES	ATTRIBUTES	ATTRIBUTES	ATTRIBUTES
Reachability ●●●●●●●●●● Intent to buy ●●●●●●●●●● Flexibility ●●●●●●●●●● Wants retry ●●●●●●●●●●	Reachability ●●●●●●●●●● Intent to buy ●●●●●●●●●● Flexibility ●●●●●●●●●● Wants retry ●●●●●●●●●●	Pay vs effort ●●●●●●●●●● Time pressure ●●●●●●●●●● Accountability ●●●●●●●●●● Incentive ●●●●●●●●●●	Gets reasons ●●●●●●●●●● Control ●●●●●●●●●● Stuck capital ●●●●●●●●●● Resale-open ●●●●●●●●●●

OUR PRIMARY RESEARCH AND ITS RESULTS

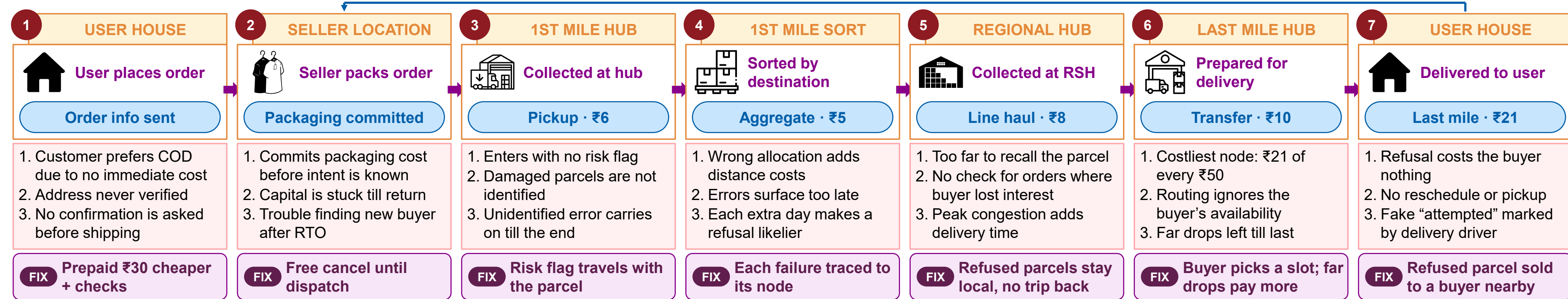
CUSTOMER	DELIVERY AGENT	COURIER VISITS	SELLER
Surveyed 64 people across 16 states and UTs on their last 3 months of online shopping  32.8% Had an order never reach them (refused or busy) 51.6% Saw "attempted" when nobody actually came 79.7% Were genuinely unavailable at least once when a rider came 61% Would collect from a pickup point within 2 km 59.4% Would pay ₹30 up front on a ₹500 COD order (70% incl. "maybe")	Spoke to 9 delivery agents who frequently deliver within campus premises - Wastes time locating addresses in the interiors, leading to missed targets - Said COD orders are more likely to be rejected - Did not want to take long trips - Unable to fulfil at least 3 orders a day (customers busy or not responding)	We interviewed 3 courier outlets about how they handle failed deliveries ST Couriers ~190 orders a day, 3 attempts; if not picked up, it goes back to the seller India Post Delivers to an alternate address (department, hostel office) if the first fails Professional Couriers Has a storage section it is willing to lease to hold parcels for a set time	Interacted with 6 sellers across different categories like jewellery, clothes and shoes "Roughly one in four orders comes back to us" (15% RTO, 11% returns) "We have to repackage after a parcel returns: more time and effort" "Sometimes parcels come back damaged or go missing, leading to losses" "Inventory freezes till the parcel is back; then we need a new buyer"

MEESHO'S RTO JOURNEY, RE-ENGINEERED WHERE COSTS LEAK TODAY AND THE NEW FLOW



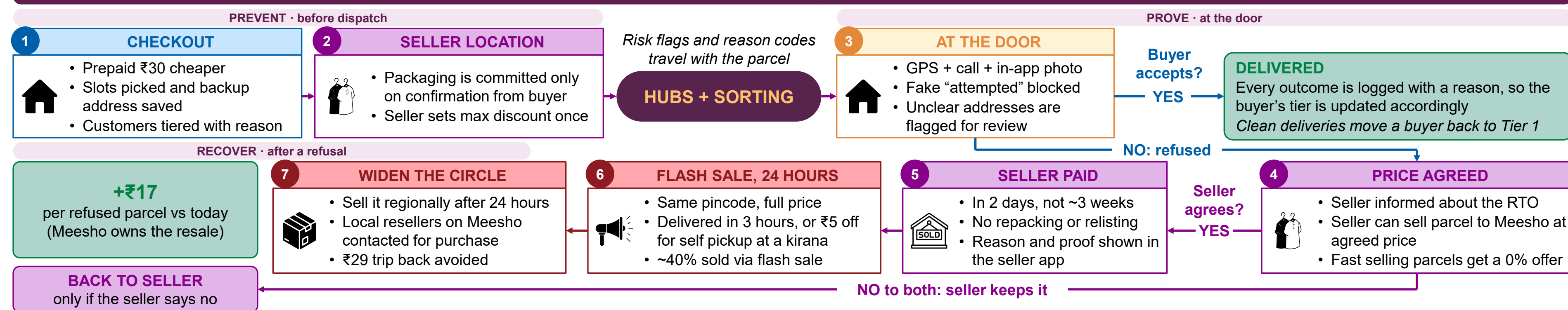
CURRENT RTO FLOW AND WHERE COSTS ARE INCURRED

Return journey to the seller: Meesho pays for both the forward and the return trip



NEW FLOW: PREVENT WHAT WE CAN, NEVER SEND THE REST BACK

Who acts: **Customer** **Seller** **Delivery agent** **Next-door buyer**



BUYER'S CHECKOUT FLOW

ALTERNATE ADDRESS, DELIVERY SLOTS, TIERING & FLASH SALE



1 · ADDRESS: REACHABLE BY DESIGN

← Back

Where should we deliver?

Keshav Tiwari

Room 14, Shree Boys Hostel, Scheme 78, Indore 452010

Landmark: Near Hanuman temple, opposite SBI ATM

1 · Phone the rider can reach

✓ Verified

98260 41 723

2 · When can someone take delivery?

Any time

9 am – 9 pm

Morning

before 11 am

Evening

6 – 9 pm

Working hours

11 am – 6 pm

Late night

9 – 11 pm

☐ Weekends only

Archit plans his route around your slot. You can change it until the parcel leaves the hub.

3 · If you're not in, leave it with... (optional)

No backup

Neighbour

Nearby shop

Workplace

Neighbour's name

Aman Verma

1 Verified phone

The buyer confirms a number the rider can reach before the order is placed

2 Delivery slot

The buyer chooses a delivery slot when someone will be available, and riders plan their route accordingly

3 Weekend delivery

If the buyer is out all week, the parcel comes on Saturday or Sunday; this can be changed until it leaves the hub

4 Backup contact

A neighbour, shop or workplace that can take the parcel, called only if the buyer doesn't pick up

2 · PAYMENT: GRADED BY RISK

Deliver to Keshav · Vijay Nagar 452010

Search by keyword or product ID

← Back

How would you like to pay?

Tier 2

Why am I seeing this?

Some past deliveries to this account came back, or this order looks likely to. A small step now helps the parcel reach you, and keeps delivery free for everyone.

It depends on your recent order history and a risk check on this order. It is not about you personally, and it resets as orders go through.

Think this is wrong? Appeal →

☒ Cash on delivery

₹30 deposit now by UPI, ₹269 at the door. The deposit comes back if it doesn't reach you.

☐ Pay online · save ₹30

₹269 now by UPI, ₹30 less than cash on delivery

Delivery for this order

- Up to 2 delivery attempts
- After 2 tries, collect within 1 day from Sharma General Store (Scheme 54, opposite SBI ATM)
- We'll ask you to confirm before it ships. Cancel free until then.
- Delivery slot: Evening, 6 – 9 pm
- If you're out: Neighbour · Aman Verma, Room 12, same hostel · 9826011223

5 Tier, explained

The buyer's tier comes from TrustMesh and past refusals; the app explains it, and the buyer can appeal

6 ₹30 off prepaid

Cash on delivery stays at ₹299 and paying online costs ₹269. Increases prepaid transactions, reduces RTO

7 Two tries, then pickup

For riskier orders we will try two delivery attempts, then they can choose to pickup from nearby kirana

8 Free cancellation

The buyer gets a reminder before dispatch; cancelling then costs nothing, instead of a ₹121 round trip

3 · A NEXT-DOOR CUSTOMER BUYS IT

← BACK

Near you · unopened

Kundan choker set with earrings

₹399

Sealed and already in your pincode, so you get it in hours instead of in 4–5 days.

Collect at Sharma General Store · ₹5 off

Ready in 1 hour · Scheme 54, opposite SBI ATM · open till 10 pm · show a 4-digit code

⚡ Delivered in 3 hours

To your door, today

Paid online, so there's nothing to settle at the door. Easy returns apply as usual.

Pay ₹394 by UPI

9 Listed nearby

The refused parcel is still sealed and already located in buyer's pincode, so nearby shoppers see it at full price

10 ₹5 off at a kirana

They can collect it from a shop down the road within an hour, using a 4-digit code

11 3-hour delivery

It reaches the buyer's door in 3 hours, instead of the usual 4-5 days

12 Paid upfront

The buyer pays when ordering, to avoid further RTO cases

HOW IT TIES INTO THE SOLUTION

Three tiers by refusal history Under 20% refusals: COD option allowed 20–60%: ₹30 deposit upfront for COD Over 60%: Only Prepaid allowed	Commitment before dispatch Paying online becomes the better deal, and cancelling before dispatch costs nothing	What our survey shows 59.4% of buyers we surveyed would pay ₹30 up front; the pilot tests whether they prepay the full order	A refusal becomes a sale A buyer's refused parcel becomes a neighbour's order within hours, instead of a ₹121 round trip
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PROBLEM & STAKEHOLDERS

SOLUTION & PROTOTYPE

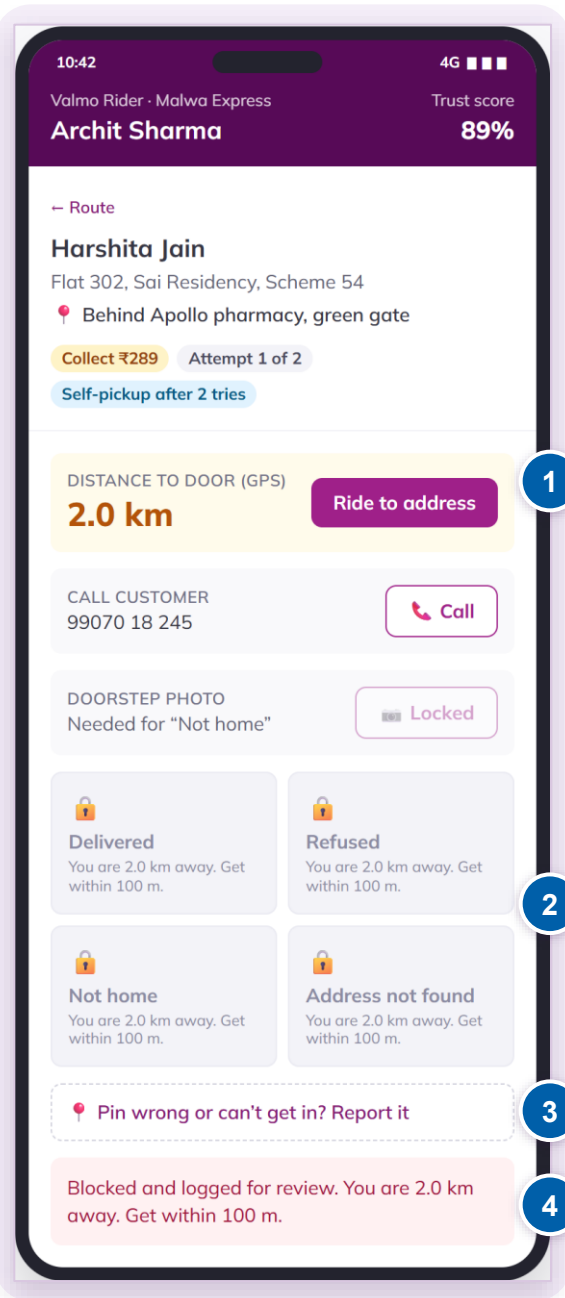
FINANCIALS, GTM & RISKS

APPENDIX

RIDER APP FLOW

NO MORE FAKE ATTEMPTS

1 · AWAY FROM THE DOOR: NOTHING CAN BE MARKED



1 GPS distance check

The app sees the rider is 2 km from the buyer's door, so the rider cannot be there yet

2 Outcomes locked

No outcome can be marked and no doorstep photo taken until the rider is within 100 m

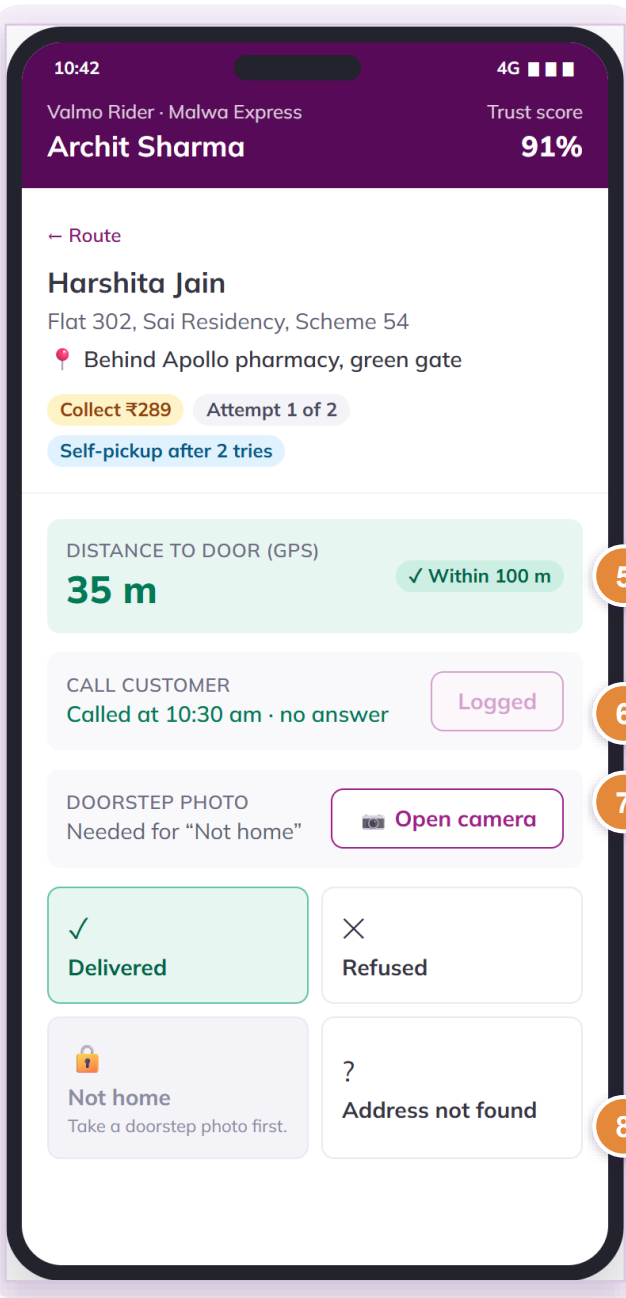
3 Wrong pin

The rider logs a call and a landmark, and a supervisor reviews it. However, it counts as an attempt

4 Fake attempts blocked

A "Not home" tapped 2 km away is rejected and never counts against the buyer

2 · AT THE DOOR: LOCKED TILL THE RIDER ARRIVES



5 100 m GPS lock

Delivered, Refused and Not home option unlock only within 100 m of the buyer's door

6 Call on record

The rider calls the buyer from the app, and the time of the call is recorded

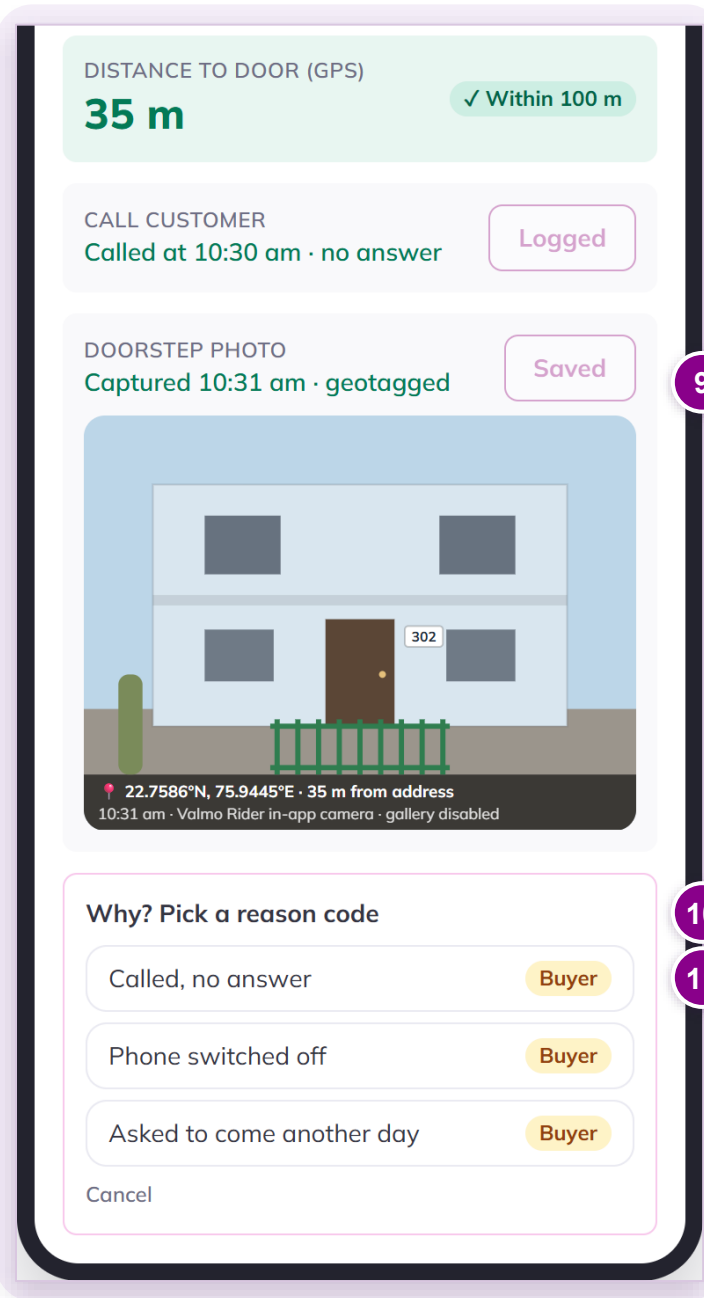
7 In-app camera only

The doorstep photo must be taken in the app; uploads from the gallery are disabled

8 Proof, then "Not home"

The photo carries GPS, distance and time; only then can "Not home" be marked

3 · EVERY FAILURE GETS A REASON



9 Photo on record

The seller and Meesho can see where and when the rider tried to deliver

10 Fixed reason codes

No answer, phone off, asked for another day, or wrong address

11 Buyer or courier?

Each failure is marked as the buyer's or the courier's, so the right party is held responsible

Courier scorecard

Failures caused by each courier partner are tracked, and the worst performers are reviewed

HOW IT TIES INTO THE SOLUTION

Why it matters

51.6% of buyers we surveyed saw "attempted" when nobody came

Pay tied to proof

The rider's trust score is the share of attempts with proof, and incentives depend on it

Extra pay for far drops

Drops over 10 km are incentivized, so that deliveries far away are not deprioritized

Fair to the rider

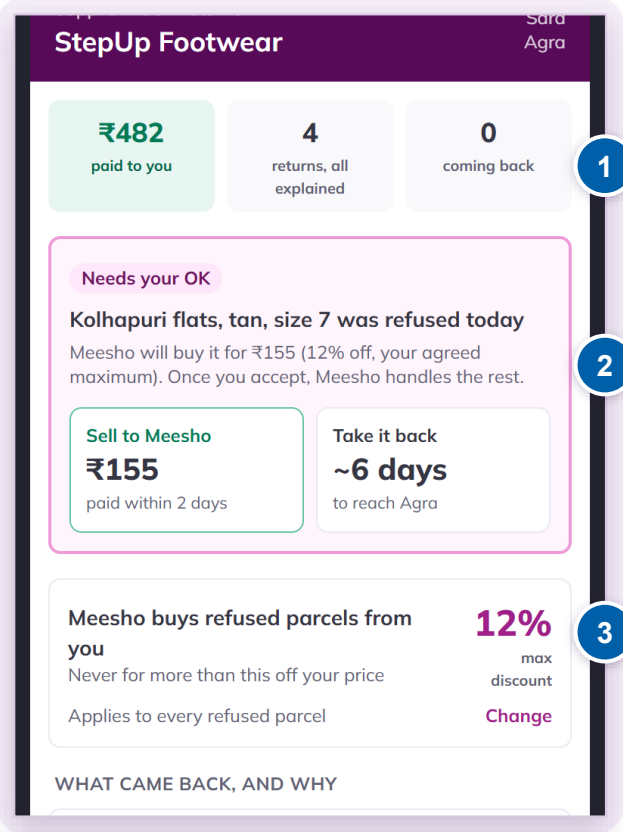
Agents told us 3+ drops a day fail. The app helps the rider deliver and never shows the buyer's tier

SELLER APP FLOW

EVERY RETURN EXPLAINED & MEESHO'S OFFER

1 · WHAT THE SELLER NEEDS, AT A GLANCE

Refused: Kolhapuri flats, ₹229



1 Money received

₹482 received so far for refused parcels sold to Meesho, each paid within 2 days

2 Meesho's offer

₹229 – 12% (₹27) – ₹47 shipping charge = ₹155. Once accepted, the parcel is Meesho's to sell

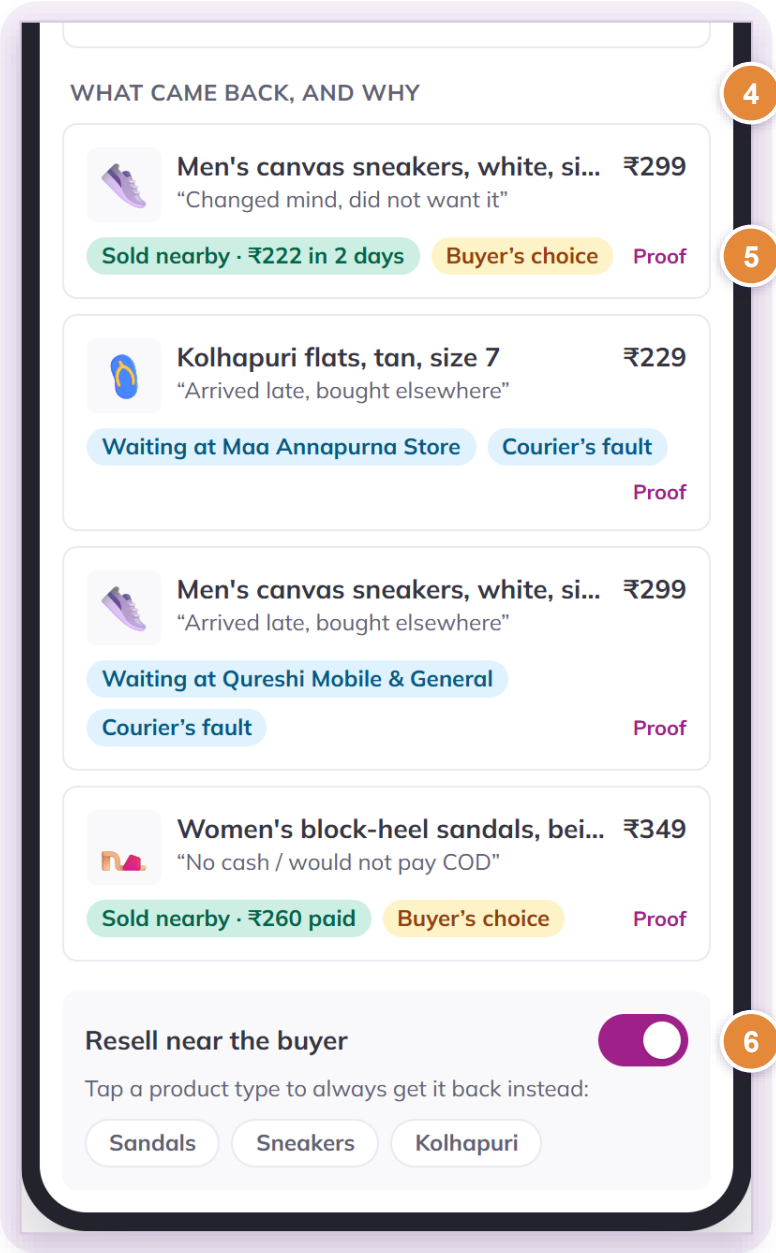
3 Discount limit

The seller agrees once with Meesho on the most discount they will accept, between 10% and 20%

Nothing to chase

All 4 RTOs are explained, and none are coming back

2 · EVERY RETURN EXPLAINED



4 Return reason

“Changed mind” is the buyer's choice; “arrived late” is a logistical fault

5 Proof attached

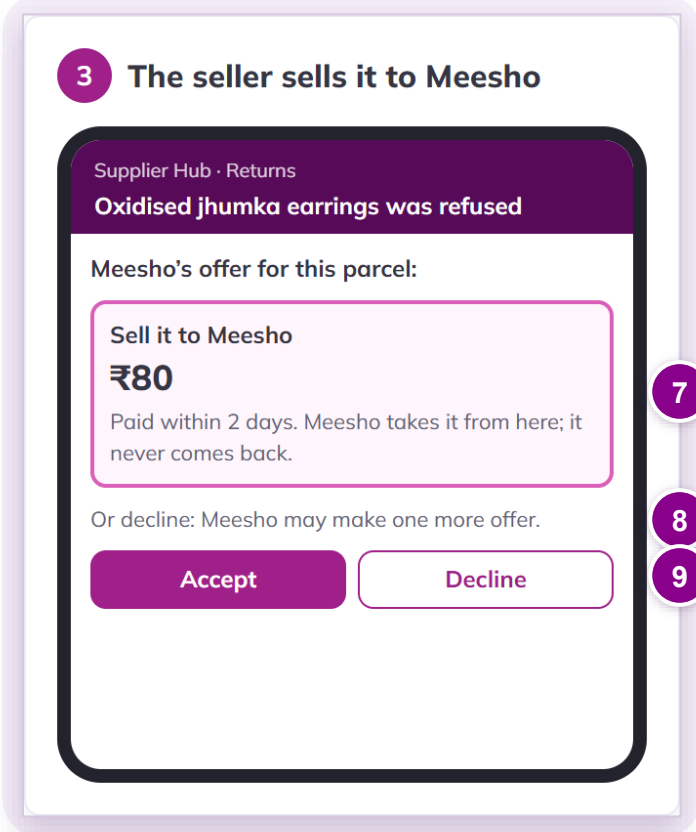
Every delivery attempt comes with GPS location, call log and doorstep photo

6 Offers on or off

The seller can turn off Meesho's offers, or exclude any product type, in one tap

3 · MEESHO'S OFFER WHEN A BUYER REFUSES

Refused: oxidised jhumkas, ₹149



7 Step 1: ₹80 offer

₹149 – 15% (₹22) – ₹47 shipping charge = ₹80, paid within 2 days

8 Step 2: 0% offer

If the seller declines: ₹149 – ₹47 = ₹102. Only for fast sellers; 63% of these jhumkas sell within 24 h

9 Otherwise returned

Parcels not expected to sell fast, or a second no, are returned as today

Seller is done

Where, when and for how much the parcel sells is Meesho's concern, not the seller's

HOW IT TIES INTO THE SOLUTION

Where the price comes from

Meesho first asks for a discount that fits the seller's margin, up to 15%. If declined, fast sellers get a 0% offer

One choice, made once

The seller sells to Meesho or takes the parcel back. After that, nothing about the parcel concerns them

Why sellers say yes

The seller is paid within 2 days, instead of waiting ~3 weeks for stock that may come back damaged

Today vs now

Today the seller sees only an RTO count. Now every return has a reason and proof, and refused parcels are paid for within days

HOW MEESHO BUYS A REFUSED PARCEL TRACING ONE PARCEL'S PRICING & JOURNEY



THE PRICE: ONE REFUSED PAIR OF JHUMKAS (₹149), AS IN THE PROTOTYPE'S PRICING TAB

1 What does the seller earn?

Seller's price	₹149
Same item wholesale price (compared)	-₹38
Shipping charge the seller pays	-₹47
Seller's profit: ₹64	43%

Seller's historical margin is ~40%

Discount that Meesho asks for: low margin up to 10%, medium 10%, high 15%

In this case, the seller is asked for a 15% discount

2 Meesho's offer: ₹80

Seller's price	₹149
15% discount (high margin)	-₹22
Shipping charge the seller pays	-₹47
Meesho pays the seller	₹80

If it went back, the parcel is worth only ₹75 to the seller: ₹149 - ₹47 shipping - ₹10 repacking - ₹9 damage risk - ₹8 opportunity cost = ₹75

Taking into account packaging and opportunity costs, seller is better off selling to Meesho

3 If the seller says no

Second offer at 0% off: ₹102
₹149 - ₹47 shipping charge = ₹102

Only for parcels that sell fast
63% of these jhumkas sell within 24 h, so Meesho still makes +₹8 (vs -₹29 today)

Says no again? The parcel goes back to the seller, as it does today

4 Meesho's result per parcel

Counted from the refusal	Jhumka = ₹149	Parcel at AOV = ₹266
Today: send it back	-₹29	-₹29
Step 1 price	+₹30	+₹22
Step 2, 0% off	+₹8	-₹10
Step 1 vs today	+₹59	+₹51

Averaged over all outcomes, after delivery and checks. The average order sells too slowly for a 0% offer

THE SAME JHUMKAS, WITH MEESHO'S MONEY AT EACH STEP

Customer Delivery agent Seller Next-door buyer Kirana

1 · Ordered Day 0 Ordered on cash on delivery, with a slot and a backup contact Meesho: ₹0	2 · Refused at door Day 4, 7 pm The buyer refuses; the rider logs GPS, call and photo Already spent ₹50 spent either way	3 · Checked Day 4, 8 pm The hub confirms it is sealed and the right item Meesho: -₹3 total: -₹3	4 · Sold to Meesho Day 4, 8 pm The seller accepts ₹80; the parcel is now Meesho's Meesho: -₹80 total: -₹83	5 · Listed nearby Day 4, 9 pm Shown as "Near you" to 70 nearby shoppers, stored in Kirana Meesho: ₹0 total: -₹83	6 · Neighbour buys Day 5, 11 am A neighbour pays ₹149 - ₹5 for kirana pickup Meesho: +₹144 total: +₹61	7 · Handed over Day 5, 6 pm The buyer shows a code; the kirana hands it over Kirana and rider are paid: -₹14 total: +₹47	8 · Result Day 6 The seller is paid ₹80; Meesho keeps the rest Meesho: +₹47 vs -₹29 if sent back
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If nobody buys it in 24 h
Meesho keeps selling it; the seller is already paid

Day 5
Not sold in 24 hours
37% of these jhumkas

Weeks 1-2
Kirana shelf at ₹134-142
22% sell here

Week 3
Whole city at ₹134
9% sell here

Weeks 4-5
Anywhere in India at ₹127
5% sell here

After week 5
Bulk resellers at ₹52
the last 1%

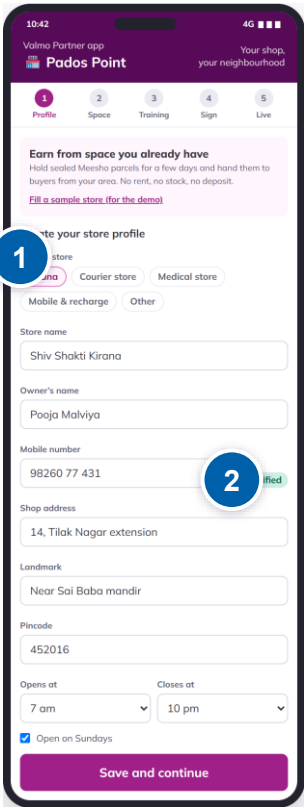
Never back to the seller
Across all these outcomes, Meesho expects +₹30, vs -₹29 today

KIRANA ONBOARDING ON VALMO END-TO-END PROCESS DEFINED

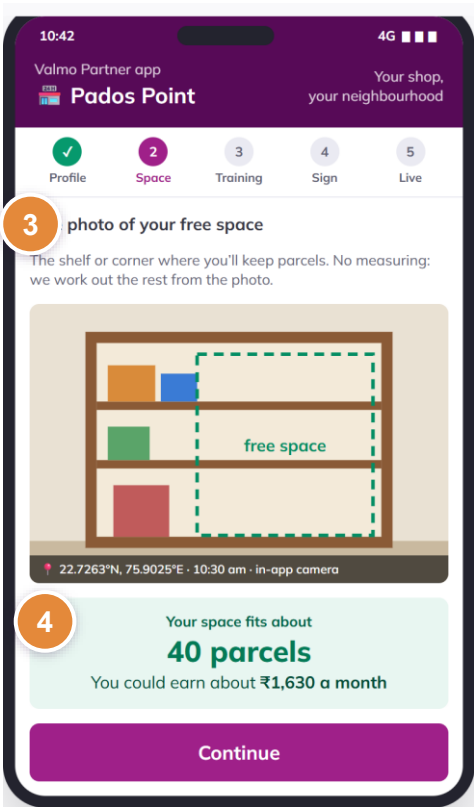


PADOS POINT (“PADOS” = NEIGHBOURHOOD): FROM SIGN-UP TO FIRST HANDOVER IN FIVE SCREENS

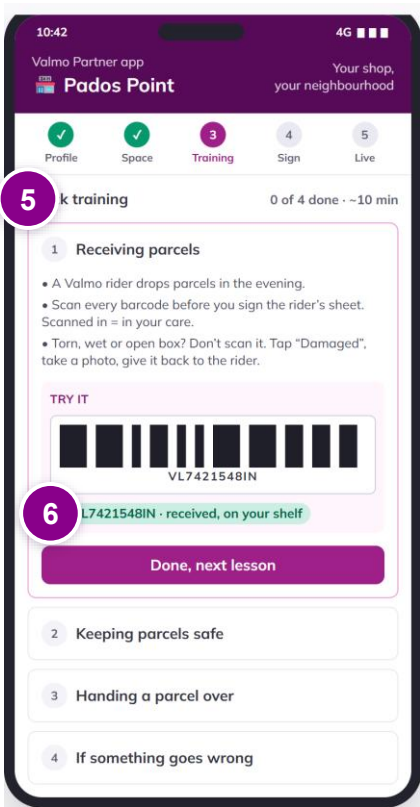
1 · Create a profile



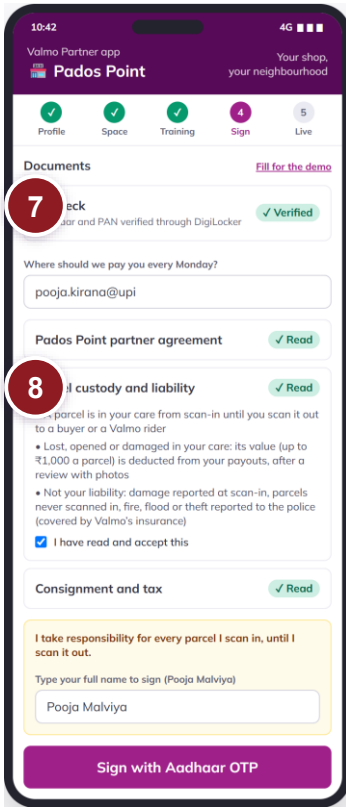
2 · One photo of the shelf



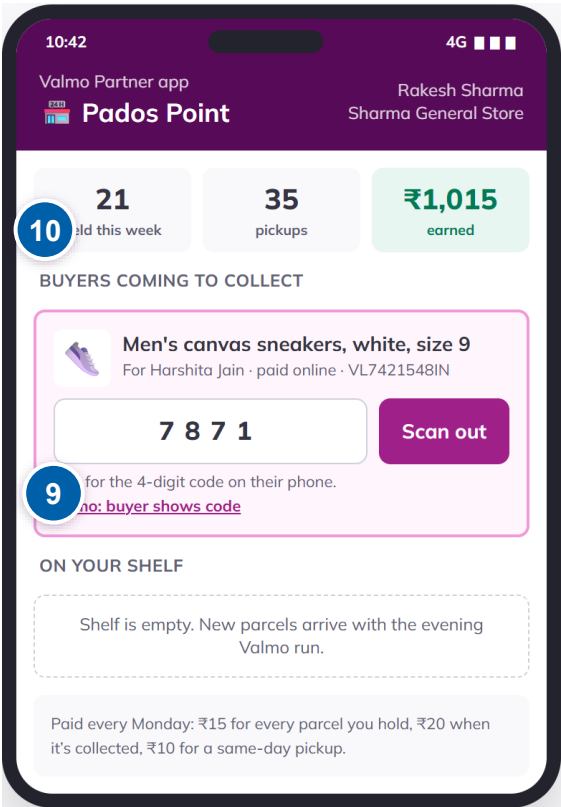
3 · 10-minute training



4 · Sign and own it



5 · The counter



1 Store profile

The kirana enters its type, owner, address and opening hours

2 Mobile verified

The owner verifies a mobile number; no documents are needed to start

3 Shelf photo

The owner photographs the free shelf in the app; no measuring needed

4 Instant estimate

The app estimates the shelf holds ~40 parcels and could earn ~₹1,630 a month

5 Short training

Receiving, storing and handing over parcels, and what to do if something goes wrong

6 Practice scan

The owner scans a real barcode and learns that a scanned parcel is in the store's care

7 ID and payouts

ID checked through DigiLocker; earnings paid by UPI every Monday

8 Custody terms

The owner signs that a parcel lost or damaged in the store's care is deducted from payouts, up to ₹1,000

9 No code, no parcel

The buyer shows a 4-digit code before the parcel is scanned

10 Earnings

₹15 per parcel held, ₹20 when it is collected and ₹10 for a same-day pickup

Why a kirana joins

About ₹1,630 a month from a shelf it already has, plus ~50 extra customers walking in increasing footfall for the Kirana. No rent, deposit or stock needed

Why it works for Meesho

One courier depot and about 7 kiranas hold a pincode's refused parcels, far cheaper than renting a warehouse

FROM PROTOTYPE TO ROLLOUT

A 30-60-90 DAY GO-TO-MARKET AND THE RISKS WE CONTAIN

30-60-90 DAY GO-TO-MARKET: PILOT, PROVE, SCALE

DAY 0-30 · PILOT

4 pincodes in Indore

- Riders log reasons with GPS, call and photo
- Flash sale goes live; it needs only software
- Buyer tiers calculated but not shown yet
- About 7 kiranas and 1 depot per pincode
- Results compared with control pincodes

Quick win: the flash sale needs no partners or investment

Go / no-go at day 30: at least 30% of parcels offered sell within 24 hours (model: 40%)

DAY 31-60 · PROVE

All of Indore

- Buyer tiers and delivery slots go live
- Meesho starts buying refused parcels
- 3-hour delivery for flash sale and ₹5 off for kirana pickup
- Tests new scheme of two attempts and then pickup
- Kiranas paid weekly by UPI

To test: two attempts then pickup saves a ₹21 trip

Go / no-go at day 60: Meesho gains ₹15+ per refused parcel and delivery stays at 83%

DAY 61-90 · SCALE

10 high-RTO cities

- Tier 2 and 3 cities where COD is common
- Valmo's field team signs up kiranas
- Unsold parcels offered city-wide, then across India
- Then 20% of Valmo pincodes in FY27, all by FY30

Quick win: Courier score cards expose the worst partners

Go / no-go at day 90: the ₹15+ gain per refused parcel holds across all 10 cities

HOW WE WIN EACH SIDE

Sellers

- Meesho buys refused parcels at an agreed price
- Nothing is bought without the seller's agreement
- A reason and proof for every RTO order
- Paid within days instead of ~3 weeks
- Can exclude any product type

Buyers

- Free cancellation until the parcel ships
- Nearby parcels shown with 3-hour delivery
- ₹5 off for kirana pickup, open till 11 pm
- ₹30 off for paying online instead of COD
- Every payment option comes with a reason

Kiranas

- About ₹1,630 a month from a small shelf
- Paid weekly by UPI, with no targets
- 10-minute training including QR scanning
- Easy signup on the Valmo app
- More customers walking into the shop

RISKS AND HOW WE CONTAIN THEM

A	Meesho stuck with unsold stock Risk: Med · Frequency: Low	<15% are unsold after 3 weeks. After that, parcels are sold in bulk deals to ensure ~100% sell through rate
B	Kirana loses or damages parcels Risk: Med · Frequency: Med	Every parcel is scanned in and out; losses up to ₹1,000 are deducted, and insurance covers theft and fire
C	Good buyer put in the wrong tier Risk: Med · Frequency: Med	Buyers can appeal in one tap; tiers need at least 5 orders, and only verified refusals count
D	₹30 prepaid discount costs margin Risk: Med · Frequency: Med	The same ₹30 for every buyer offered COD, never more for riskier ones; each refusal it prevents saves ₹121
E	Riders game the proof Risk: Med · Frequency: High	GPS, calls, and photos are taken in-app which prevents fraud. Random audits are also done.
F	Seller says no to Meesho's price Risk: Low · Frequency: Med	If the seller declines, fast sellers get a second offer at 0% off; other parcels return as today

HOW MEESHO CAN LEVERAGE ITS STRENGTHS

TrustMesh

- Already predicts RTO before dispatch and has cut it by 10%+
- Today it only blocks or allows an order; we add detailed tiering
- Becomes one input to our buyer tiers

Valmo's network

- ~6,000 partners and ~15,000 pincodes, with no heavy assets
- A local holding point is a routing change, not new investment
- Courier depots can double as holding points

Micro-entrepreneurs

- Valmo already onboards local operators
- Kiranas are the same kind of partner, now holding parcels
- Each kirana earns ~₹1,630 a month, paid weekly

SIMILAR STRATEGIES IMPLEMENTED AROUND THE WORLD

Optoro, US

Resells returns instead of shipping back; 91% resold

Amazon India

~28,000 kiranas hold parcels via "I Have Space"

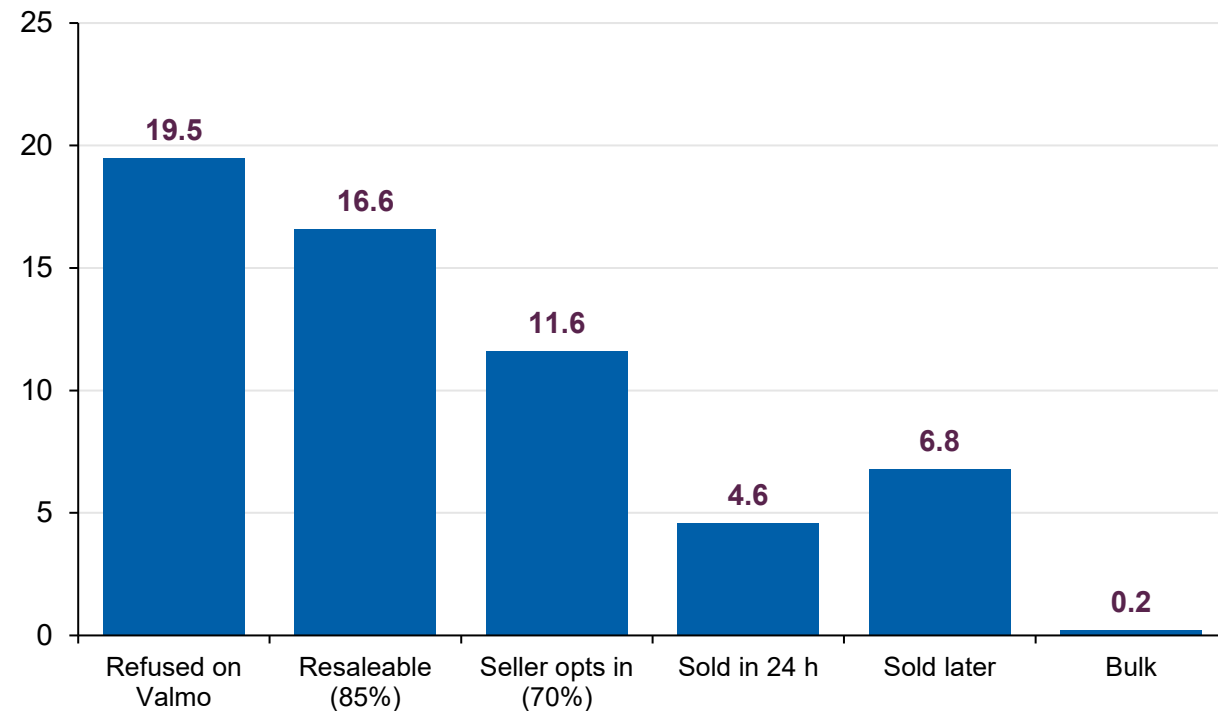
Cainiao, China

170,000+ stations hold parcels locally

SAVINGS CREATED FROM OUR SOLUTION

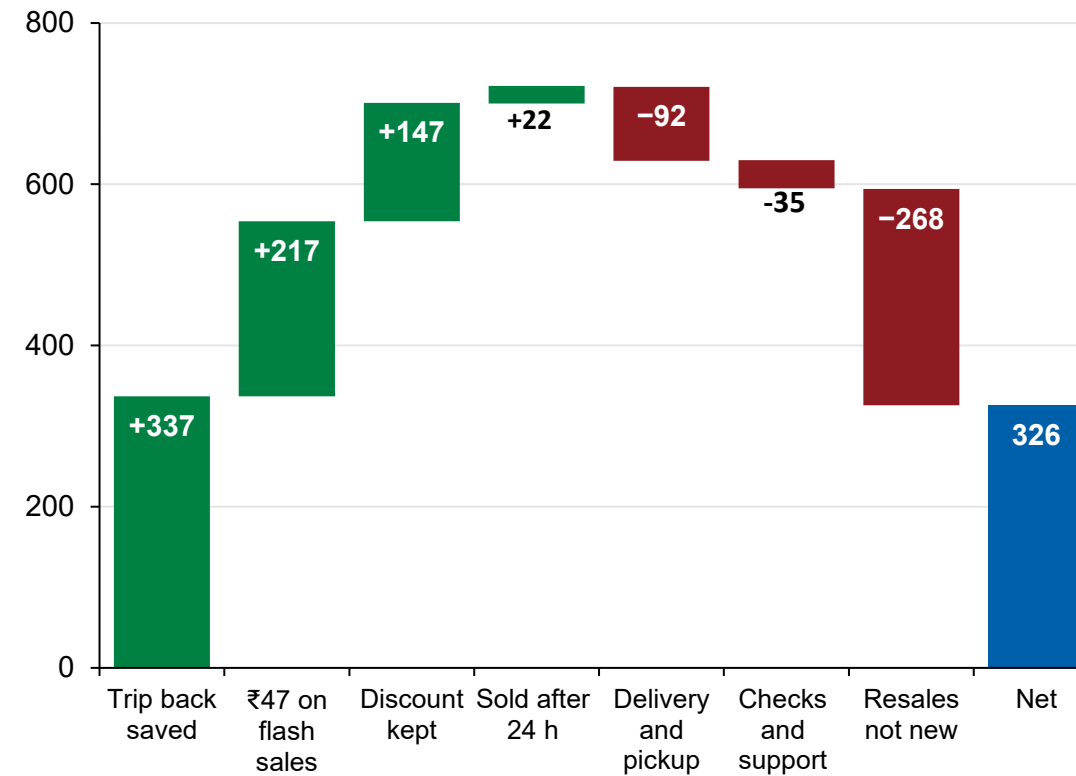
BASE RECOVERY OF ₹326 CR A YEAR & ₹118 CR MORE AFTER PILOT

WHERE VALMO'S REFUSED PARCELS GO, CR A YEAR



Sold in 24 h: 40% of parcels offered, 24% of all refused

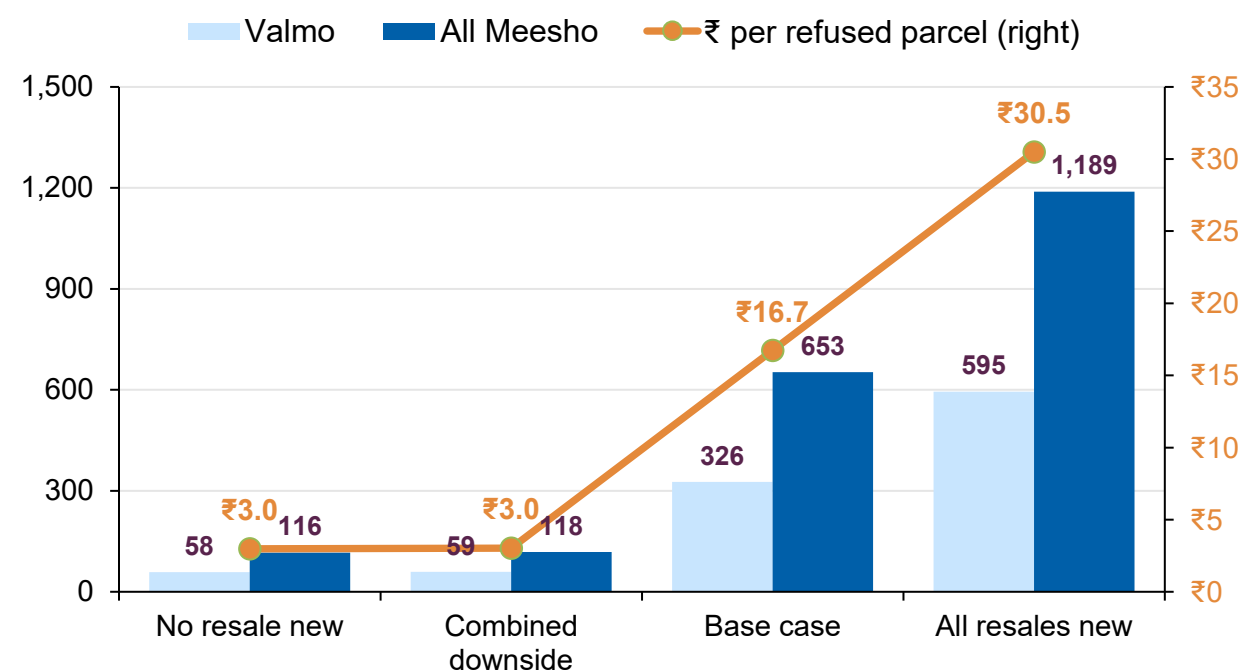
FULL-SCALE YEAR ON VALMO, ₹ CR



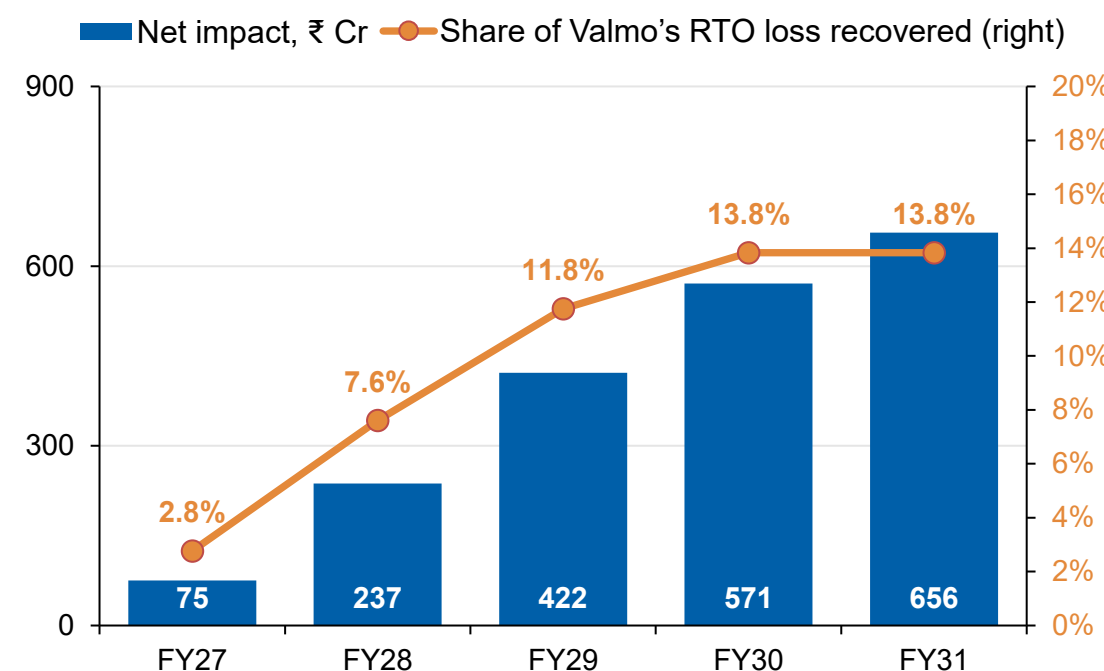
WHAT WE MEASURE AGAINST CONTROL PINCODES

Metric	Model expects	Why it matters
Gain per refused parcel	₹17 vs today	The business case
Sold in 24 hours	~40%	The biggest driver of profit
Resales that are new orders	50% assumed	Decides what the ₹47 adds
Delivered to the original buyer	83%, not lower	Recovery must not hurt delivery
Buyers switching to prepaid	To be measured	Discounts must win new prepaid buyers
Rider earnings per hour	Not lower	Proof must not cut rider pay

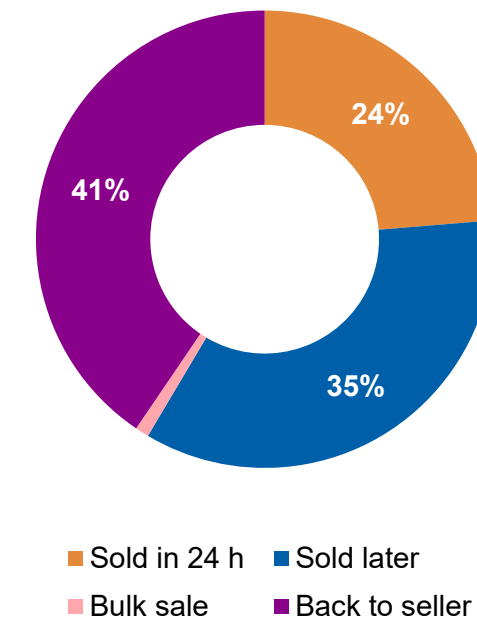
SENSITIVITY, ₹ CR A YEAR



NET BY YEAR ON VALMO: ₹1,962 CR IN 5 YEARS



WHERE REFUSED PARCELS END UP, AND WHAT WE ASSUME

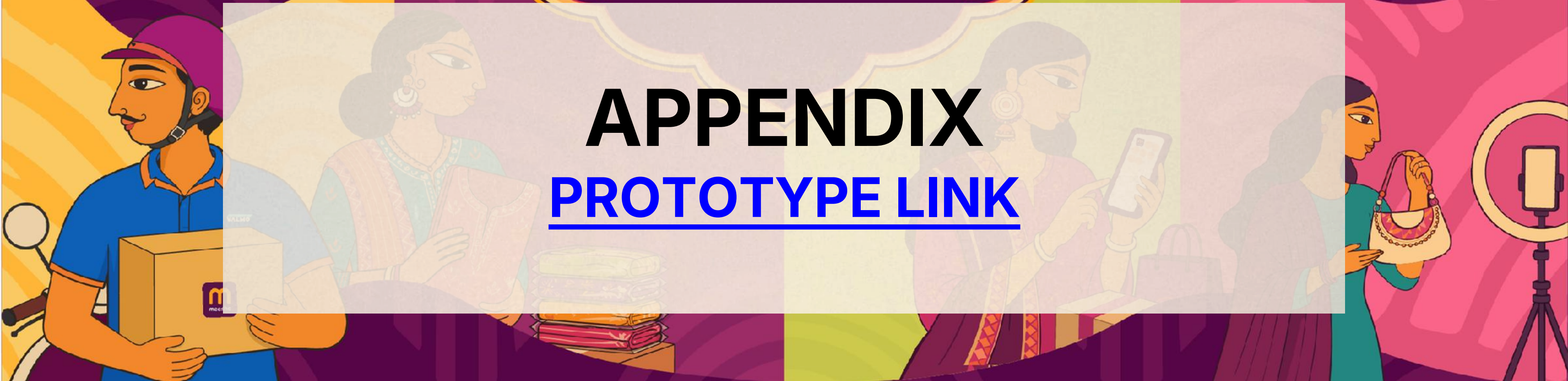


Assumption	Base case
Resales that are new orders	50%
Sold in the 24 h flash sale	40%
Average discount from the seller	12%
Resaleable refused parcels	85%
Sellers who sell to Meesho	70%
Valmo pincodes live	All by FY30



APPENDIX

[PROTOTYPE LINK](#)



Primary Research: Visits to Two Couriers and India Post



ST Couriers:

They handle around 190 orders a day and also have the same 3 delivery attempts concept as Meesho. If the parcel isn't picked up, then it is sent back to the seller



Professional Couriers:

They also service orders in and around Chennai. They have a storage section that they are willing to allow to lease out and store parcels for a set amount of time.



India Post:

We visited the post office inside the campus premises. They have an alternate address as the teachers and students are busy in classes often. In case unavailable at home, parcels for teachers are provided at department building and at hostel office for the students.

Seller Interviews: 6 Sellers, 3 on Text and 3 on Call (Shared With Consent)

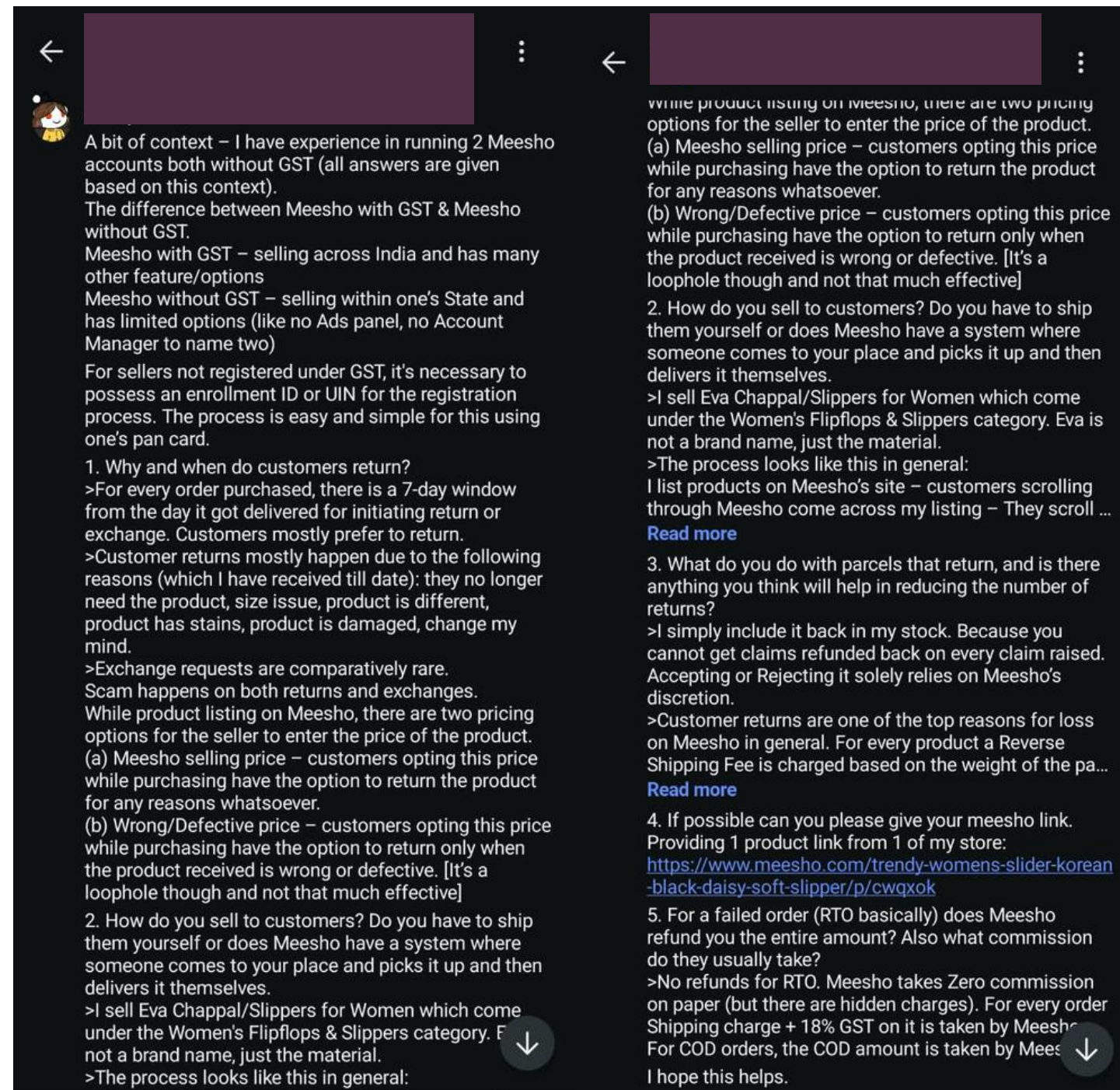
Summary of Interactions:

RTO runs 15–22%, returns 11–52% depending on category
No RTO fee, no refund from Meesho, but the seller bears packaging and reverse shipping

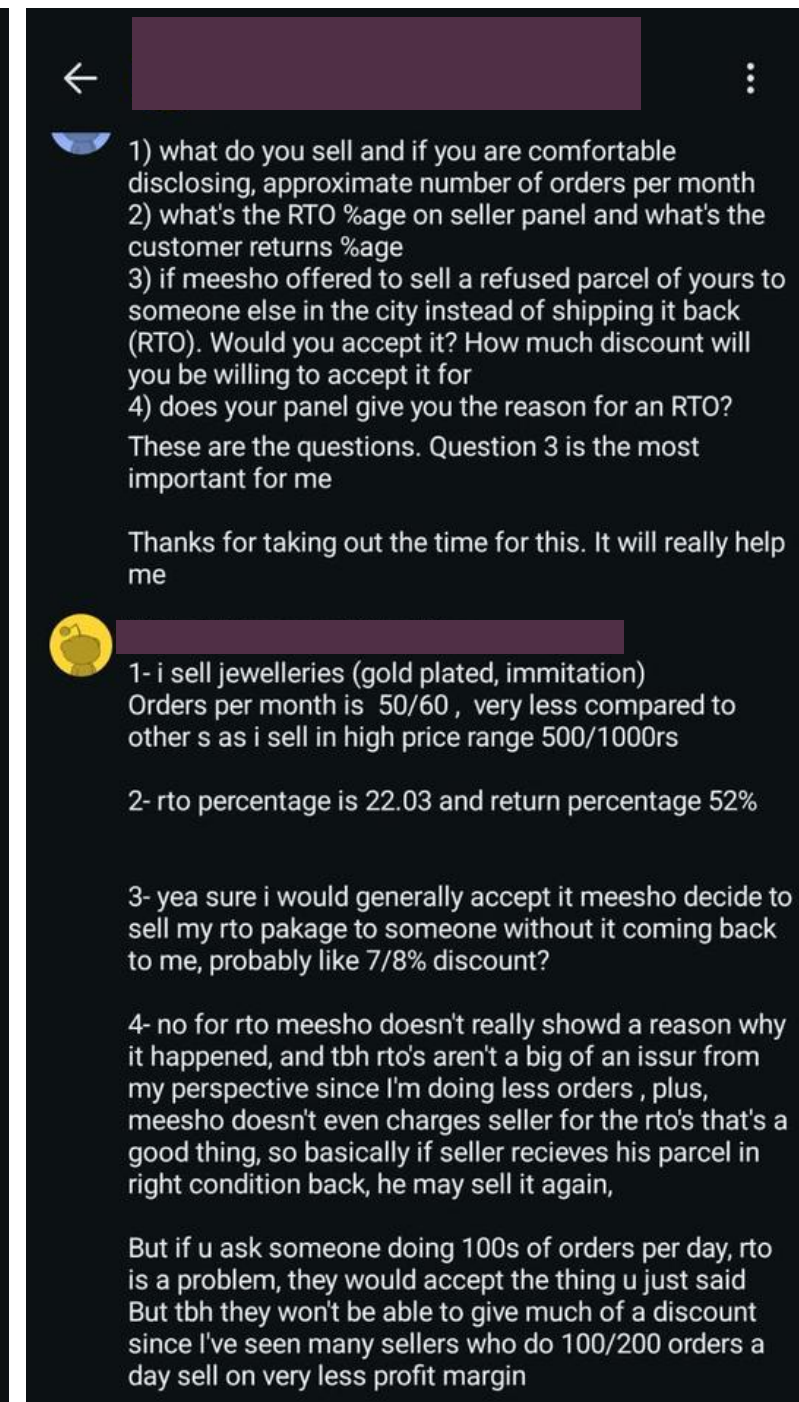
Sellers will accept local resale at up to 20% discount on high-margin items

Returned stock often arrives damaged or missing, with claims at Meesho's discretion
Smaller sellers are far more willing to discount than high-volume sellers on thin margins

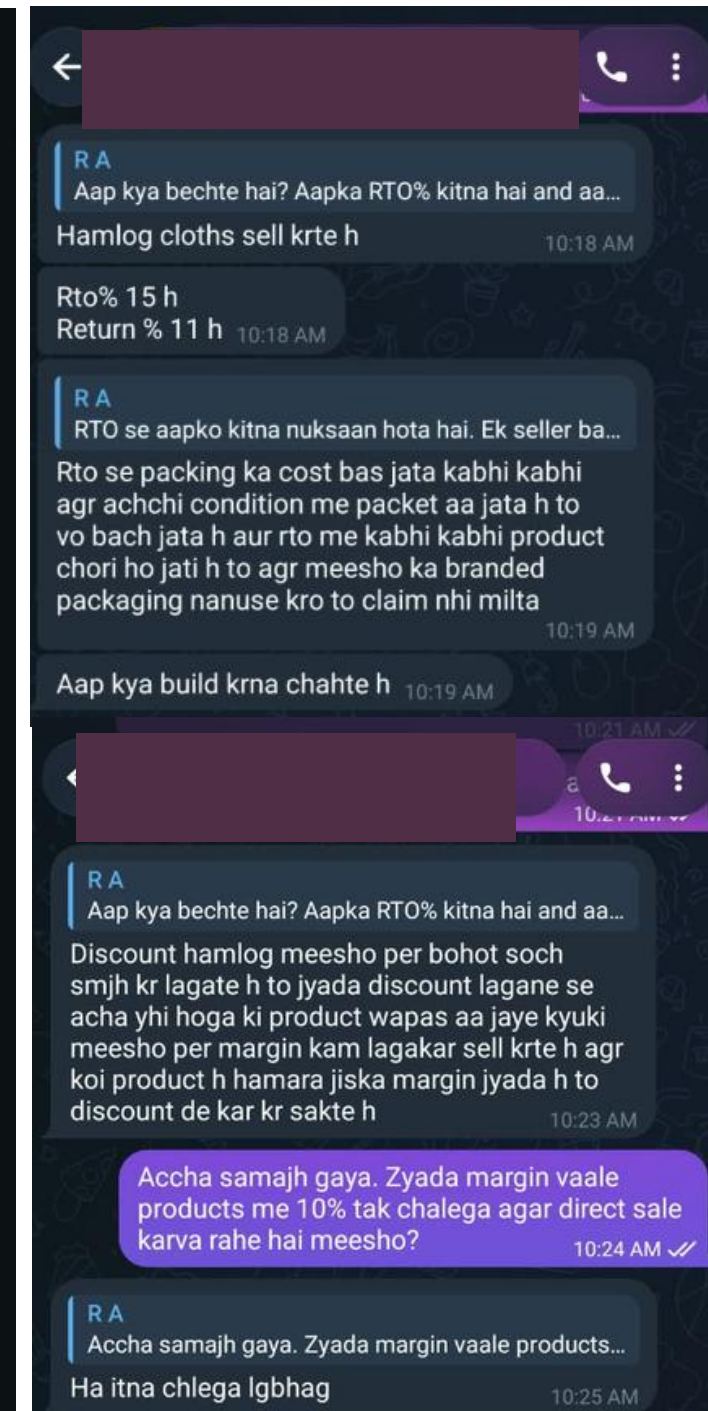
Screenshots from telegram & reddit interactions



Seller 1 on Reddit

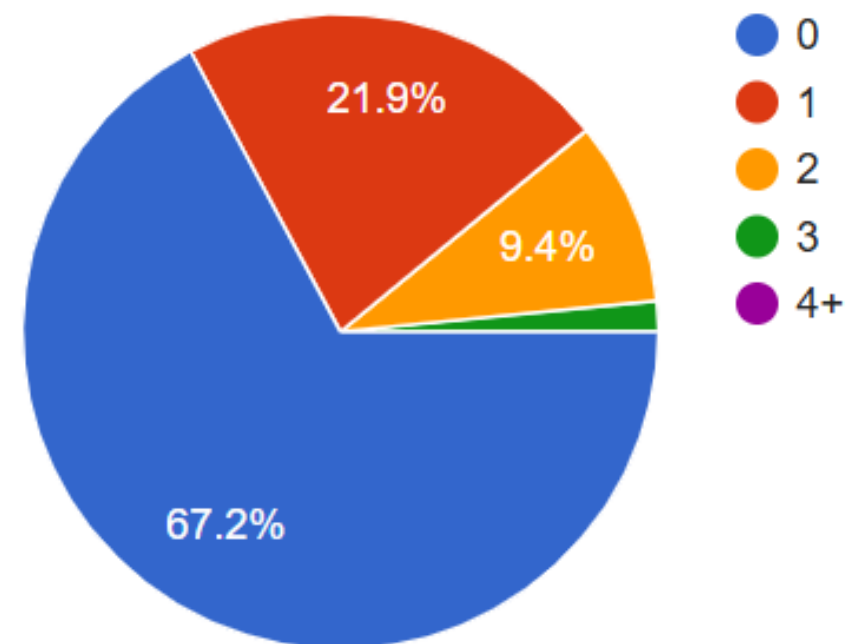
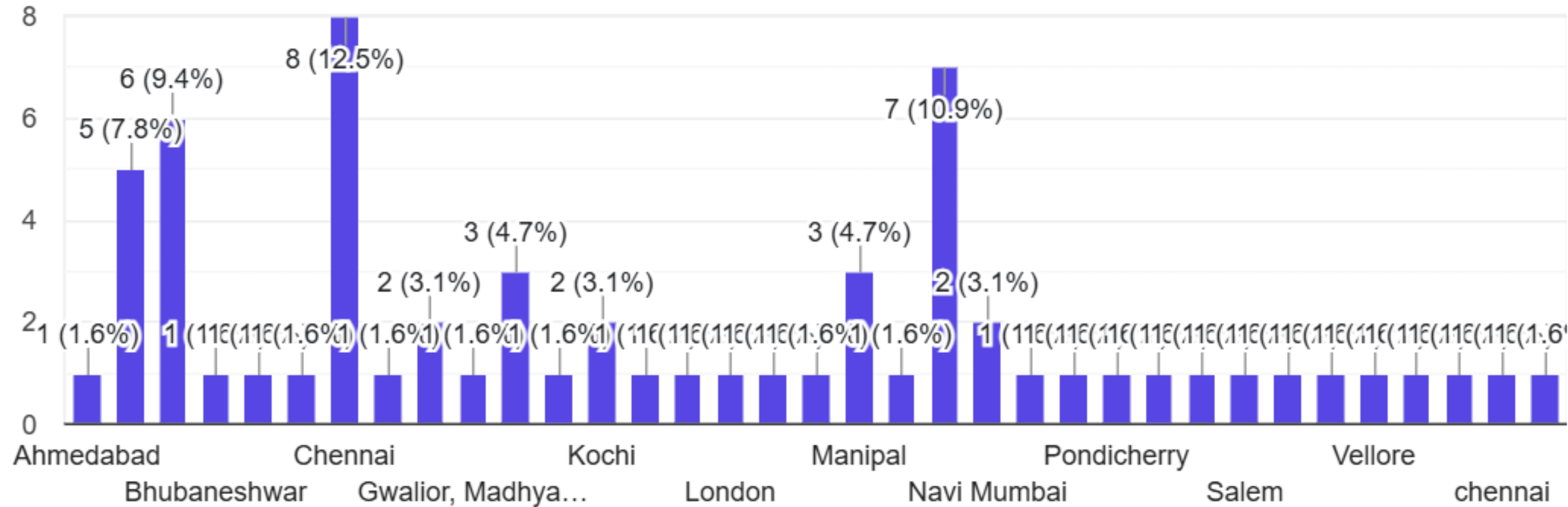


Seller 2 on Reddit

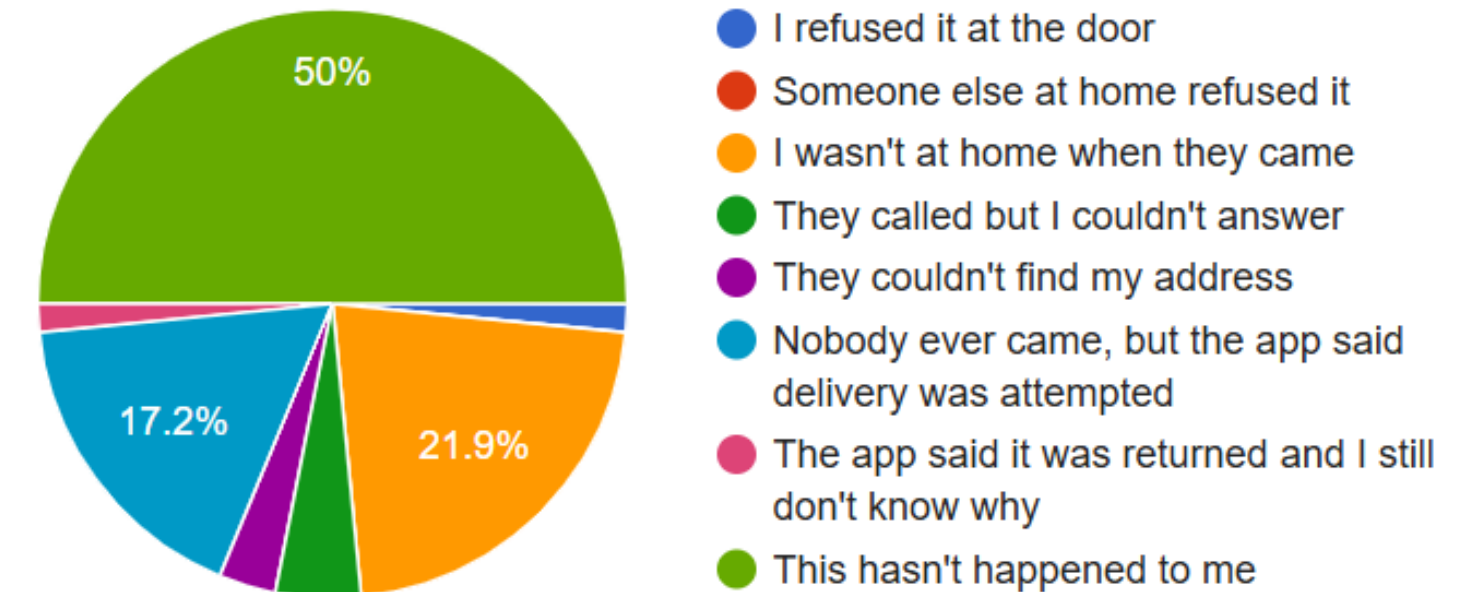


Seller 3 on Telegram

Customer Survey Results (I/IV): Orders That Never Reached Buyers, and Why

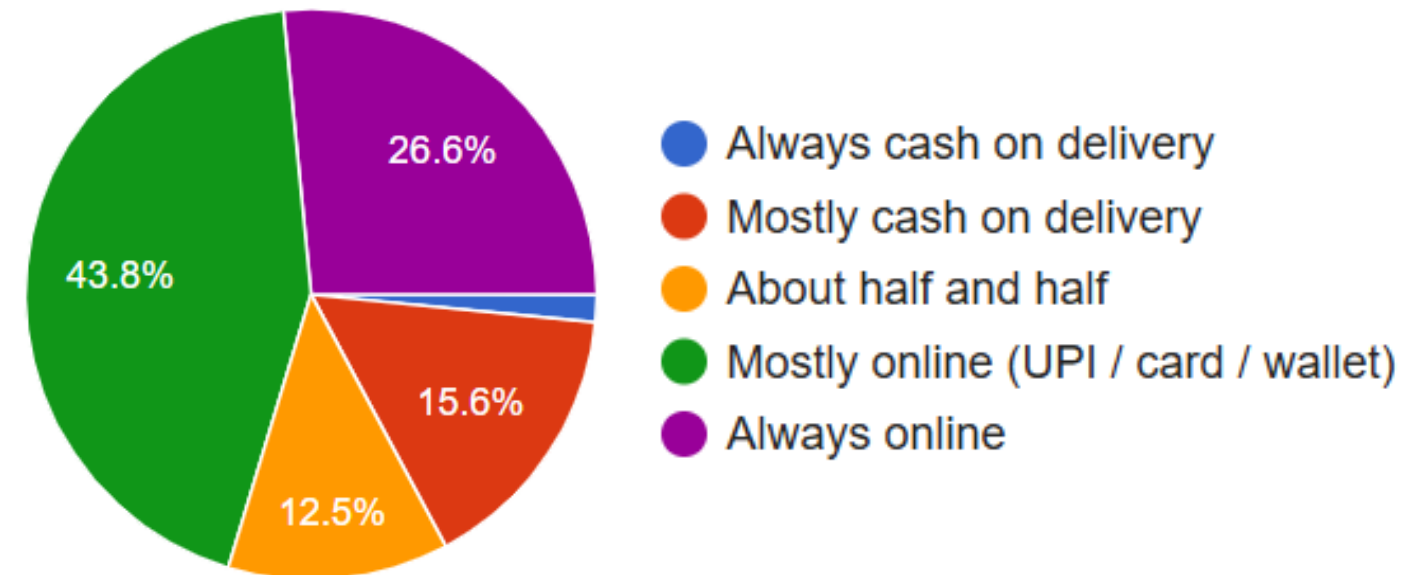


Reason behind the orders not reaching?

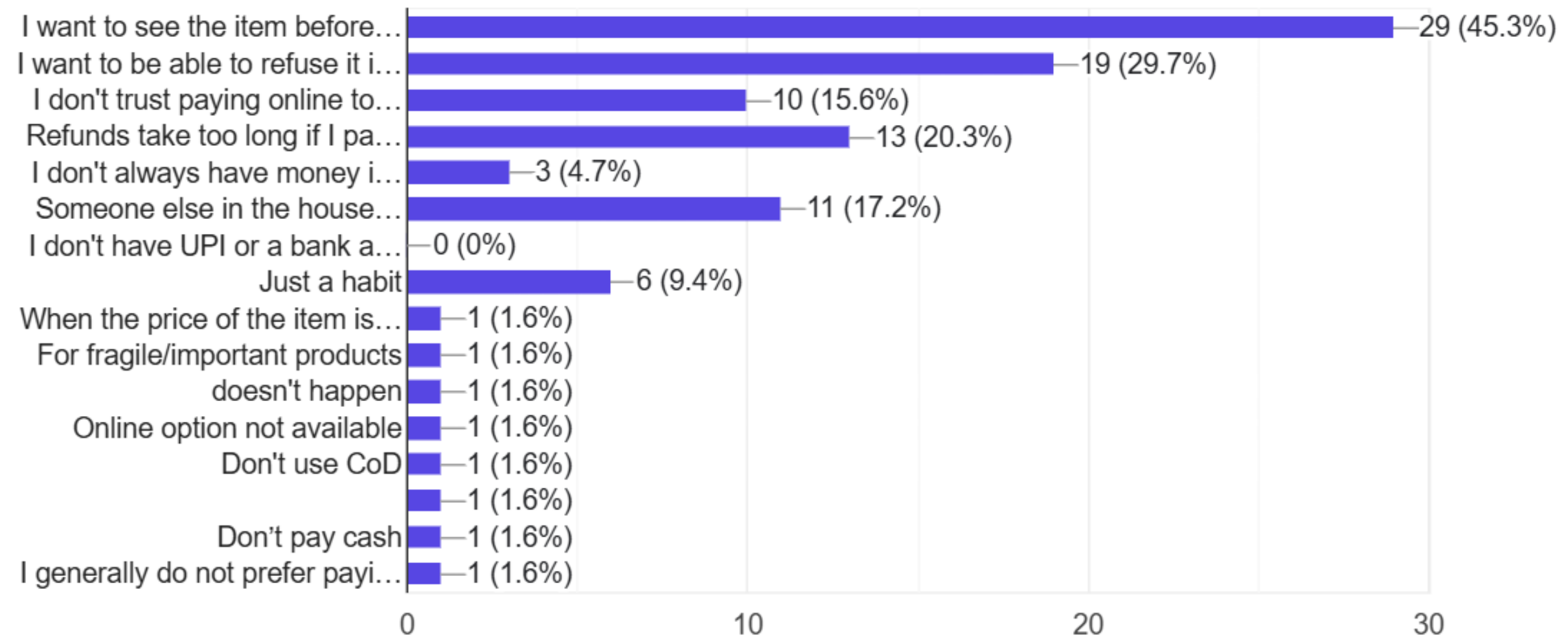


Customer Survey Results (II/IV): How Buyers Pay, and Why They Pick COD

How do you usually pay for the orders?



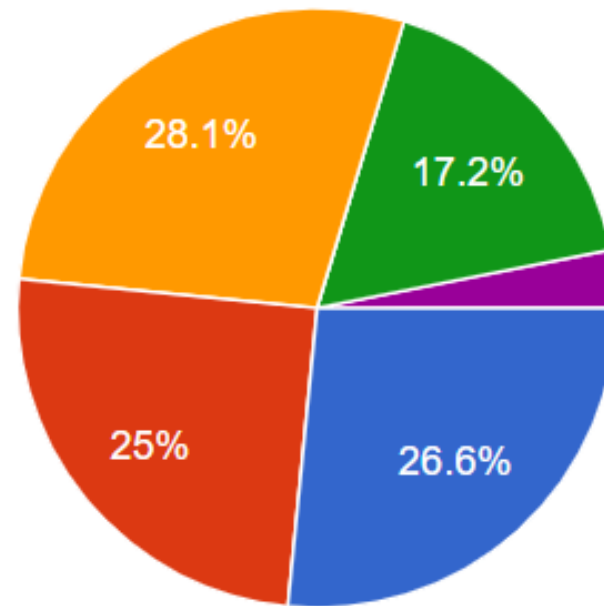
Why is COD preferred?



Customer Survey Results (III/IV): Fake Attempts and Missed Deliveries

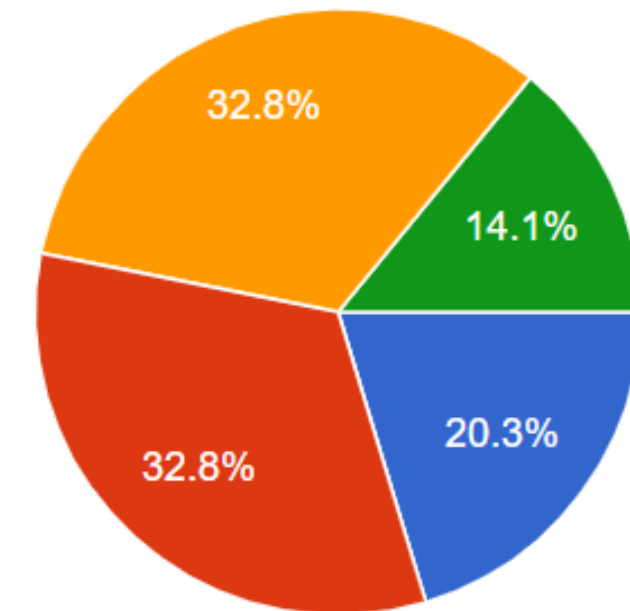


app showed "delivery attempted" or "customer not available" but nobody actually came and nobody called you?



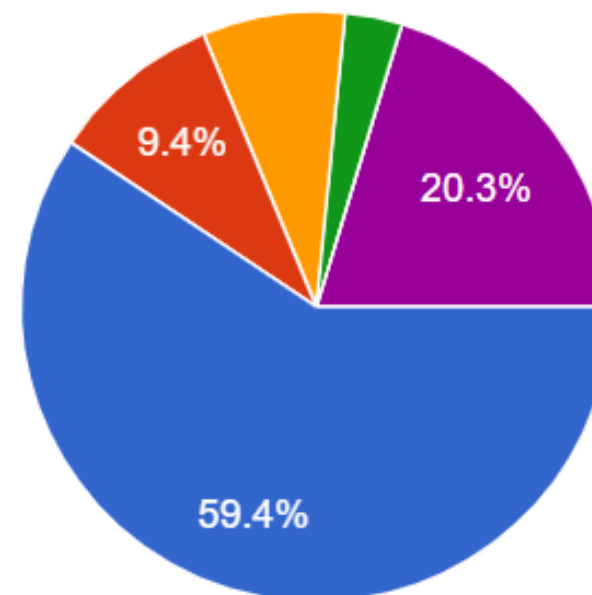
- Yes, more than once
- Yes, Once
- No
- No, I'm not sure
- I don't check

how many times were you genuinely not available when a delivery person came?



- Never
- Once
- 2-3 times
- 4 or more times

That order that didn't reach you: did it eventually get delivered?

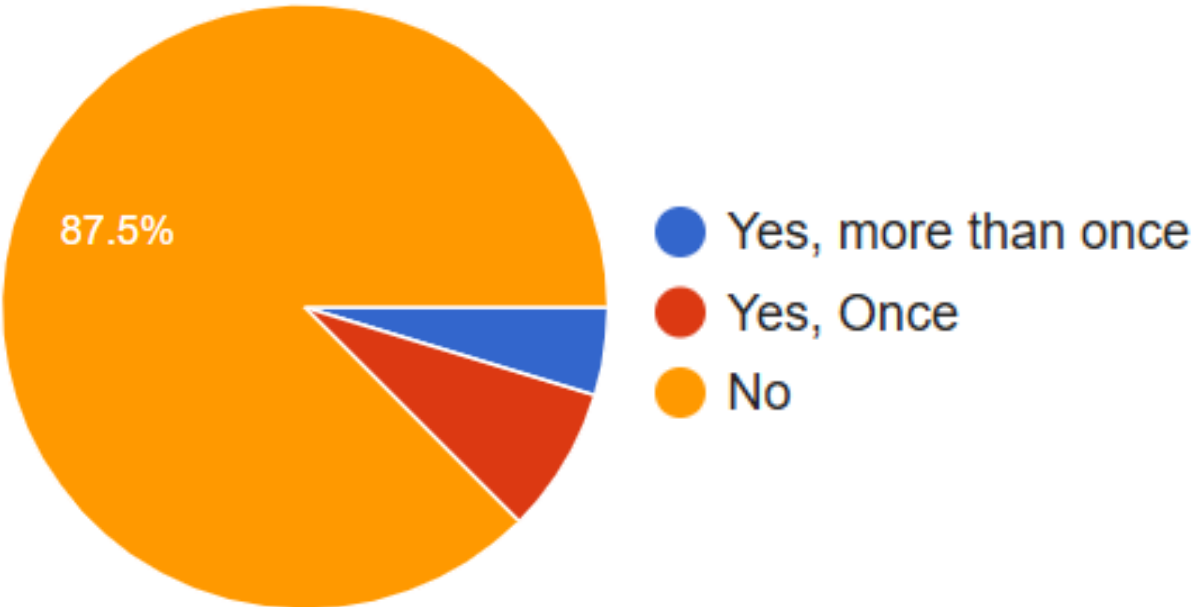


- Yes, on the second attempt
- Yes, but it took three or more attempts
- No, it went back and I never got it
- I cancelled it myself
- This hasn't happened to me

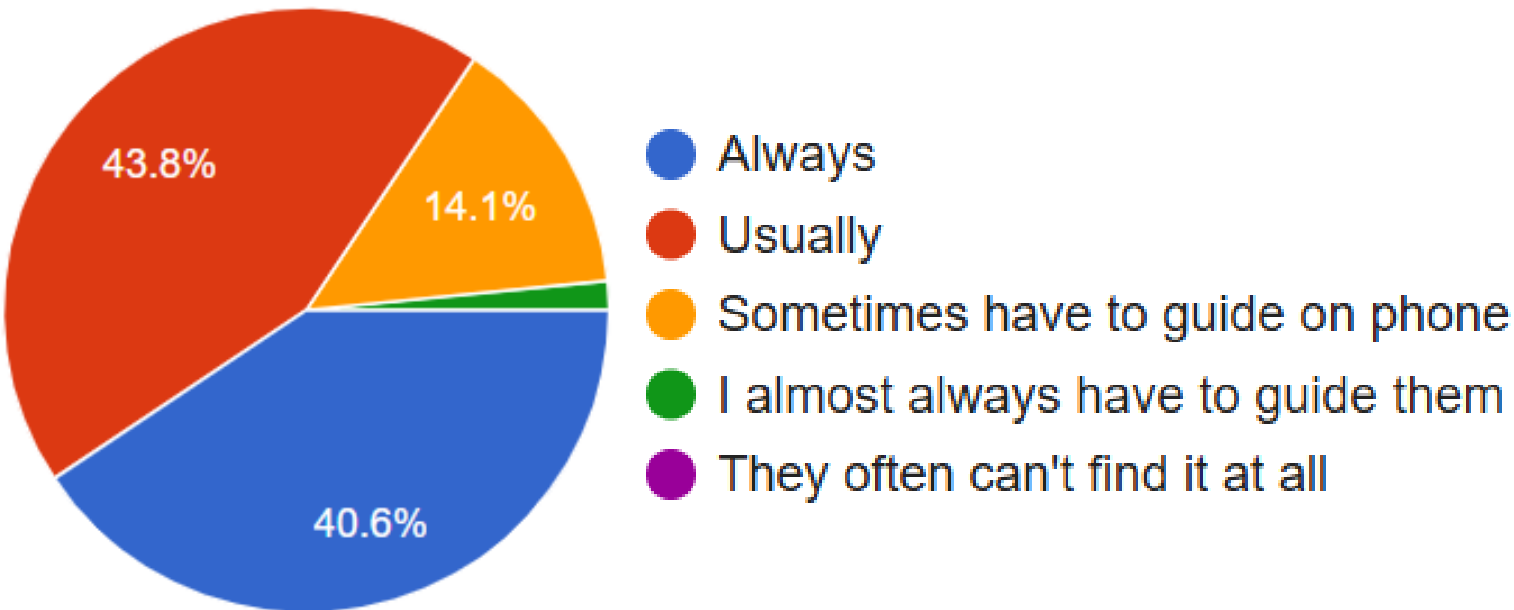
Customer Survey Results (IV/IV): Refusals at the Door and Finding the Address



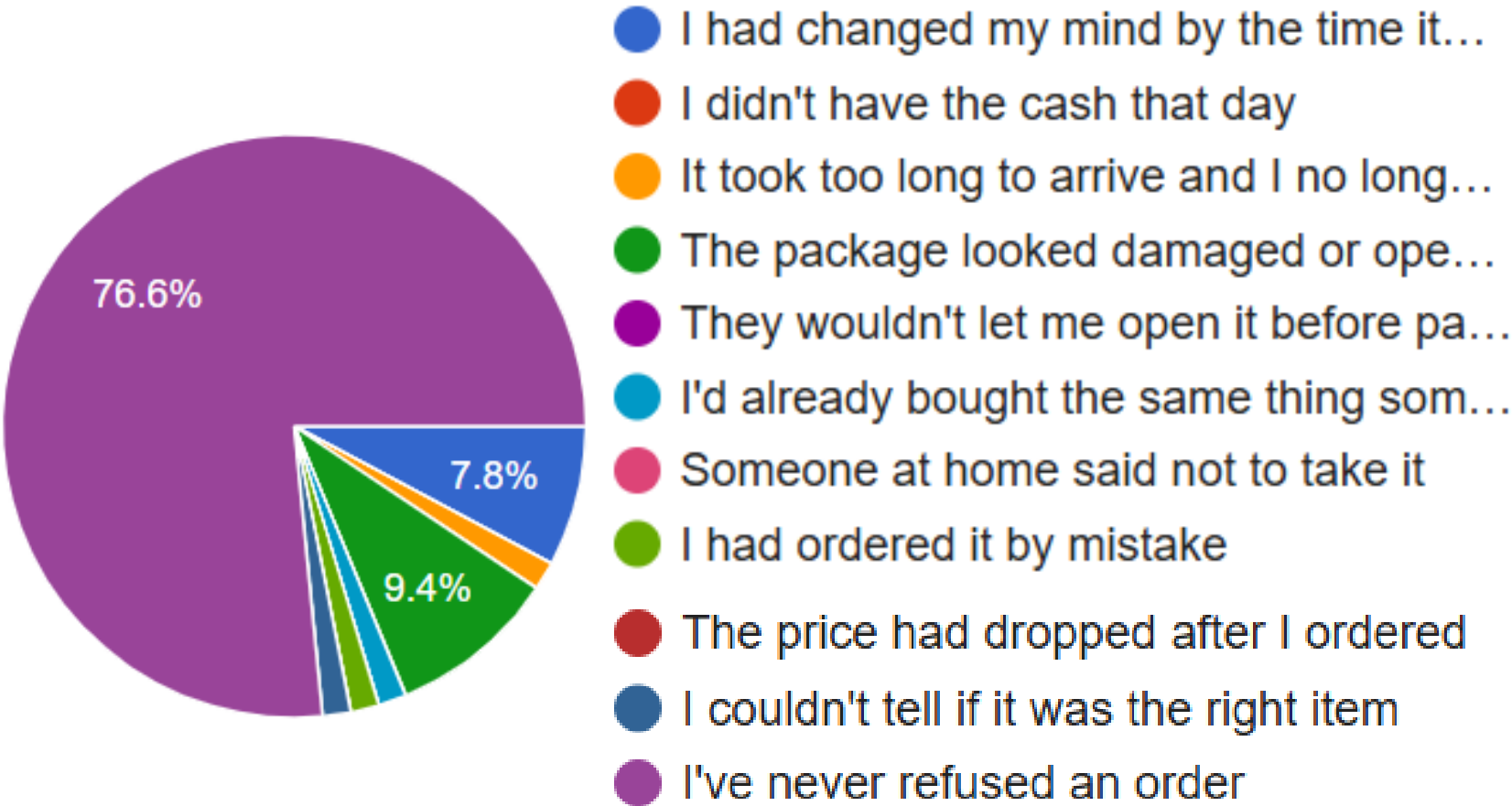
Have you ever refused an order at the door, before paying?



Do delivery people usually find your address on the first try?

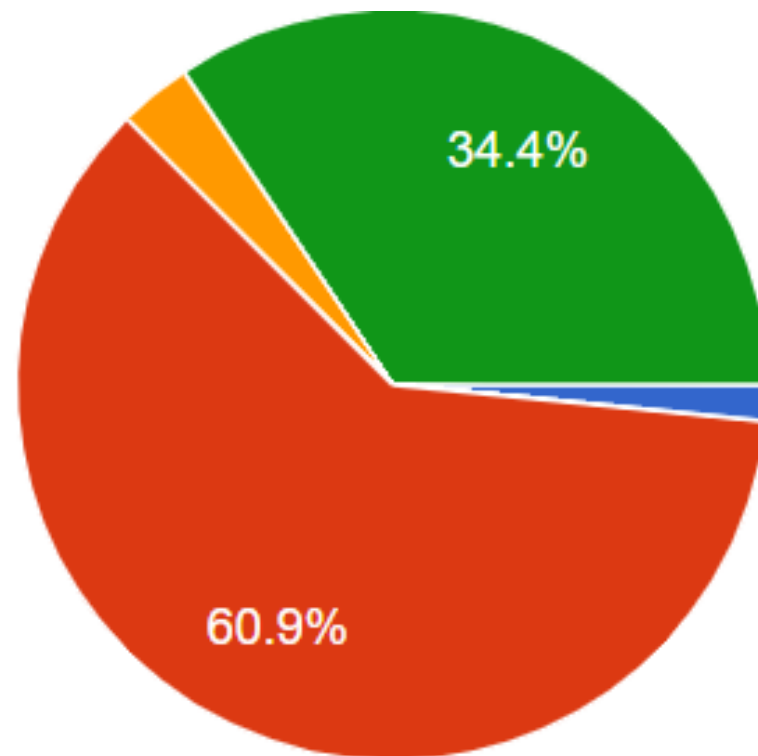


The last time you refused, why was that the case?



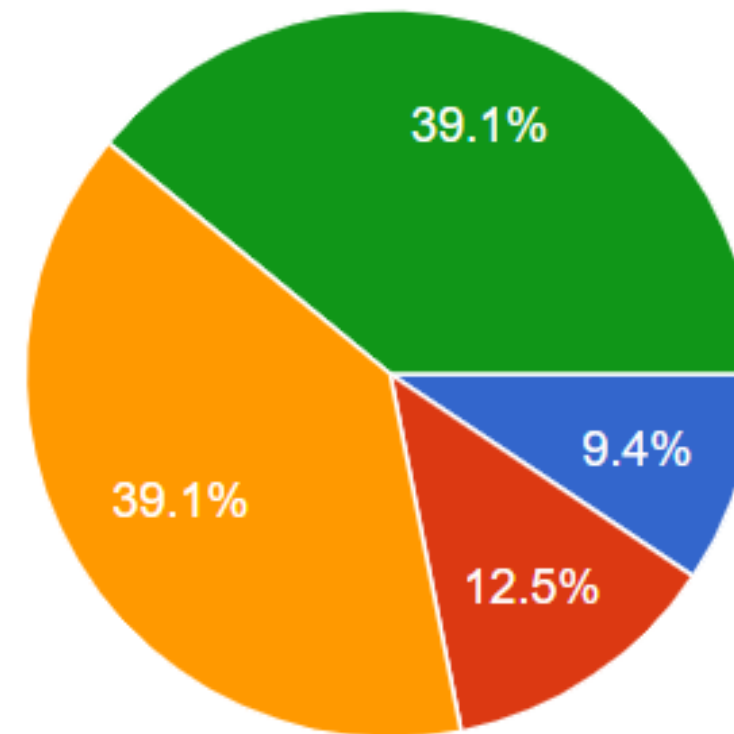
Customer Survey: How Buyers Rated Our Proposed Fixes

If you weren't going to be home, would you let the parcel be delivered somewhere else nearby?



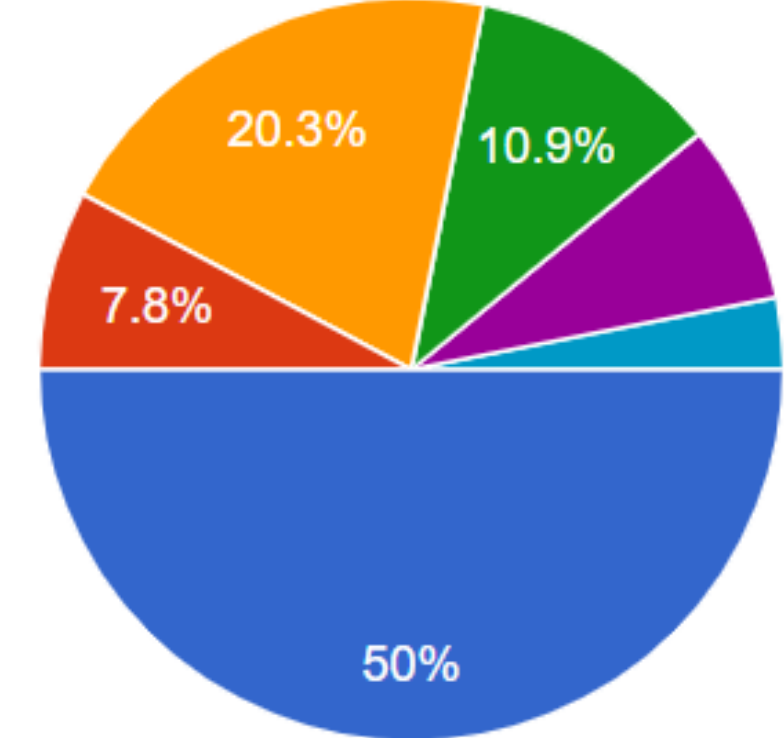
- Yes: to my workplace
- Yes: to a relative or neighbour
- Yes: to a nearby shop I trust
- No, only to my own address

If your order couldn't be delivered, would you collect it yourself from a location within 2 km?



- Yes
- Yes, if I got a small discount or cashback
- Only if it was very close
- No

You order something for ₹500 with cash on delivery. The app asks you to pay ₹30 now by UPI, and you pay only ₹470 when it arrives. Would you do it?



- Yes, that's fine
- Yes, but only for expensive orders
- No, I wouldn't like this
- Maybe, depends on the order value
- No, that defeats the point of cash on delivery
- Yes

Delivery Agent Interviews: 9 Agents, in Their Own Words

We interviewed 9 delivery agents about RTOs: how they handle them, far-off deliveries and incorrect addresses. Here is a summary of what they told us.

It is very frustrating when we have to travel far to deliver orders but the customers aren't there to receive it. In the same time we could have delivered 2-3 orders and earned more money. I travelled 12km and no one opened the door.

Many times customers open the door and look at the parcel and refuse it without even opening, then I have to carry it for the rest of the day and return it back to hub. I also end up wasting one delivery trip.

Sometimes, the addresses which we get are unclear, no house number or incorrect landmarks which waste a lot of time for us to find. Sometimes we don't even know if the address is correct or wrong. We have to keep calling the customer and asking

Nowadays when I see a parcel is COD I get worried about taking the trip as a lot of the rejections from customers happen on these parcels only where they open the door but still do not pay, this is very frustrating for us also.

I usually deliver the closer addresses first and then move on to the further ones as we get paid the same for both, so there is no incentive for us to deliver the further parcels early on in the day.

Delivering far away orders is frustrating. Once I called and confirmed that the customer was at home but when I reached they were not available and said I had taken too long. This is frustrating and I wasted a lot of time.

GMV, NMV and RTO Sizing:
Meesho’s Reported Numbers, on Shipped Orders



REPORTED FINANCIALS, ₹ CR UNLESS STATED

Line item	Q4 FY26	Annualised	Note
GMV	19,054	76,216	Reported
NMV	11,614	46,456	Reported
Returns, refunds, cancellations	7,440	29,760	GMV less NMV
Orders placed (Cr)	71.7	286.8	Reported
Average order value (₹)	265.75	265.75	GMV ÷ orders

ASSUMPTIONS FROM THE BRIEF AND MANAGEMENT

Assumption	Value	Source
COD share of orders	80%	Problem statement
RTO rate on COD / prepaid	20% / 5%	Problem statement
Blended RTO rate	17%	80% × 20% + 20% × 5%
Orders shipped / placed	80%	Management commentary
Cost of one RTO parcel	₹121	Node costs in the brief (A3)

RTO VOLUME AND LOSS ON SHIPPED ORDERS

Line item	A year
Orders shipped	229.4 Cr
COD / prepaid	183.6 / 45.9 Cr
RTO on COD (20%)	36.7 Cr
RTO on prepaid (5%)	2.3 Cr
RTO parcels, all Meesho	39.0 Cr
RTO loss at ₹121 each	₹4,720 Cr
As a share of NMV	10.2%
GMV of parcels that never arrive	₹10,366 Cr
On Valmo (about half)	19.5 Cr · ₹2,360 Cr

Why shipped, not placed

- An RTO happens only to a parcel that ships. Applying 17% to orders placed (48.8 Cr, ₹5,899 Cr) overstates it; the base case uses 39.0 Cr
- Valmo delivers about half of shipped orders: 19.5 Cr RTO parcels and ₹2,360 Cr a year, the base for every model slide that follows
- The GMV of parcels that never arrive, ₹10,365 Cr, is sales Meesho books but never delivers

Model Inputs: What Meesho Disclosed, What the Brief Gave Us and What We Assumed



DISCLOSED BY MEESHO

Input	Value	Source
GMV, Q4 FY26	₹19,054 Cr	Q4 FY26 investor filing
NMV, Q4 FY26	₹11,614 Cr	Q4 FY26 investor filing
Orders placed, Q4 FY26	71.7 Cr	Q4 FY26 investor filing
Annual transacting users	264 Mn	Q4 FY26 investor filing
Users outside top-8 cities	88%	Q4 FY26 investor filing
Contribution margin	4.6% of NMV	Q1 FY27 commentary
Orders shipped / placed	80%	Management commentary

GIVEN IN THE PROBLEM STATEMENT

Input	Value	Source
COD share of orders	80%	Problem statement
RTO rate, COD / prepaid	20% / 5%	Problem statement
Forward node costs	4/2/5/8/5/5/21 = ₹50	Problem statement
Reverse cost per failure	~₹120	Problem statement
Second-attempt failure	40%	Problem statement
Failure by hub distance	15% / 17% / 22%	Problem statement

DERIVED FROM THE TWO TABLES ABOVE

Number	Value	How
Orders placed a year	286.8 Cr	71.7 Cr × 4
Orders shipped a year	229.4 Cr	80% of orders placed
RTO parcels a year	39.0 Cr	17% of shipped (COD 20%, prepaid 5%)
On Valmo	19.5 Cr	Valmo delivers about half
Cost of one RTO parcel	₹121	2 × ₹29 network + 3 × ₹21
RTO loss a year, all Meesho	₹4,720 Cr	39.0 Cr × ₹121

OUR ASSUMPTIONS FOR THE BASE CASE, TO BE TESTED IN THE PILOT

Input	Value	Basis
Valmo's share of shipped orders	50%	Business Standard: Valmo handles half
Refused parcels that can be resold	85%	Sealed, right item; sellers say 8–10% come back damaged
Sellers who opt in to local resale	70%	Seller interviews; the rest take it back
Sold in the 24 h flash sale	40%	Demand funnel, box below
Price Meesho pays the seller	Price – 12% – ₹47	Average of 10% and 15%; 0% second offers not in the base case
Widening the circle	Kirana → city → India	5–15% off; 35–60% sell a week; bulk at 35% of price
Usual shipping charge on a resale	₹47	Illustrative; Meesho takes 0% commission
Resales that are new orders	50% (range 0–100%)	The rest would have bought on Meesho anyway
Buyers who collect from a kirana	50%	Survey: 61% would, within 2 km
Home drop / kirana pickup	₹21 / ₹19	Pickup: ₹10 kirana + ₹4 rider stop + ₹5 off
Kirana: per parcel held / collected	₹15 / ₹20	Amazon “I Have Space” benchmark
Seal check, support, payments	₹3 a parcel	Assumption
Money tied up in bought parcels	24% a year	Seller working-capital cost
2 tries + pickup (pilot test only)	40% of RTO	Riskier buyers; not in the base case
3rd try would have delivered	20%; half collect	Cap test only; a lost delivery loses ₹47

Where the 40% flash-sale figure comes from

- Chance a refused parcel sells in 24 h = $1 - (1 - \text{reach} \times \text{conversion})^{\wedge} \text{shoppers}$. Average pincode: 36 shoppers of that category and size a day, 70% see the “near you, today” card, 2% buy → 39.8%. Busy pincode (jhumkas, 70 shoppers) → 62.7%; quiet one (24) → 28.7%

Cost Model: ₹121 per RTO Parcel Today,
and Where Valmo’s 19.5 Cr Refused Parcels End Up



COST OF ONE RTO PARCEL, ₹

Node	₹ per leg	Legs today	Legs, new policy
First-mile hub	4	2	2
First-mile carting	2	2	2
First-mile sort centre	5	2	2
National line haul	8	2	2
Last-mile sort centre	5	2	2
Regional line haul	5	2	2
Last mile, per attempt	21	3	2.6 (avg)
Total per RTO parcel		₹121	₹112.6

THE 2-TRY CAP: A SEPARATE PILOT TEST

Step	A year
RTO parcels from riskier buyers (40%)	7.80 Cr
Reach a 3rd attempt today (÷ 0.8)	9.75 Cr
3rd try would deliver (20%)	1.95 Cr
Half collect from the kirana; lost	0.98 Cr
Saved: a ₹21 attempt each	+₹164 Cr
Lost: the ₹47 charge each	−₹46 Cr
Net, if the test passes	+₹118 Cr

₹120, ₹121 AND ₹29: WHAT EACH MEANS

Number	₹	What it covers
Reverse cost per failure (brief)	~120	Our reading: an all-in cost
Our cost of one RTO parcel	121	2 × ₹29 network + 3 × ₹21
Trip back saved if sold locally	29	The return network leg only
Spent before the buyer refuses	71–92	₹29 + 2 or 3 × ₹21

WHERE VALMO’S REFUSED PARCELS END UP

Stage	Cr a year	% of RTO
RTO parcels on Valmo	19.50	100.0%
Damaged or wrong item: back to seller	2.93	15.0%
Seller says no: back to seller	4.97	25.5%
Offered for local resale	11.60	59.5%
Sold in the 24 h flash sale	4.62	23.7%
Not sold in 24 h; Meesho keeps selling	6.99	35.8%
Sold at a kirana, weeks 1–2	4.03	20.7%
Sold across the city, week 3	1.77	9.1%
Sold anywhere in India, weeks 4–5	0.99	5.1%
Bulk to local resellers	0.19	1.0%
Never sent back	11.60	59.5%

Recovery is not prevention: we report them separately

- **Delivered to the original buyer:** 83%, unchanged by recovery; 82.2% only if the cap ran with no pickup
- **Physically back to the seller:** 40.5% of RTO, down from 100%. **Resold to a new buyer:** 58.5%
- **Cleared in bulk:** 1.0% of RTO, off-platform at 35% of price
- Prevention (tiers, prepaid discounts, slots) is measured in the pilot: each point of RTO it removes is worth ~₹116 Cr
- The 40% flash-sale figure is of parcels offered for resale: about 24% of all refused parcels



Annual P&L on Valmo: ₹326 Cr a Year When Meesho Buys and Resells Refused Parcels, Line by Line



THE FULL-SCALE YEAR ON VALMO		
Line	₹ Cr a year	How it is worked out
Trip back avoided	+337	11.6 Cr parcels offered × ₹29
₹47 margin on flash sales	+217	4.6 Cr sold in 24 h × ₹47
Discount kept on flash sales	+147	4.6 Cr × ₹32 (12% of ₹266)
Parcels sold after 24 h, net	+22	≈₹3 each on 7.0 Cr: resale less ₹187 paid and costs
Flash delivery and pickup	−92	Flash sales × ~₹20 (home ₹21 or kirana ₹19)
Seal check and support	−35	Parcels offered × ₹3
Resales that aren't new orders	−268	Resales × ₹47 × 50%
Net from recovery	326	₹16.7 per RTO parcel; ₹28.1 per parcel offered
2-try cap test, if it passes	+118	Separate pilot test, not in the base case (A2)

PER PARCEL MEESHO BUYS, ₹	
Line	₹ per parcel
Trip back avoided	+₹29.0
₹47 margin on flash sales	+₹18.7
Discount kept on flash sales	+₹12.6
Parcels sold after 24 h, net	+₹1.9
Flash delivery and pickup	−₹8.0
Seal check and support	−₹3.0
Resales that aren't new orders	−₹23.1
Net per parcel offered	₹28.1

ONE AVERAGE REFUSED PARCEL	
Deal, per refused parcel (₹266)	Meesho
Today: send it back	−₹29
Meesho buys it at ₹187	+₹22
Better than today by	₹51

How to read it

- Each line is against today, where every refused parcel goes back
- The ₹47 is real cash on each resale, but it may replace an order the shopper would have placed anyway: none new gives ₹58 Cr, all new ₹595 Cr
- Parcels still unsold after 24 hours barely pay their way (~₹3 each): the flash sale earns the money, including the discount Meesho keeps
- Not counted: prevention (≈ ₹116 Cr per RTO point removed), the 2-try cap (+₹118 Cr if it passes) and parcels bought through the 0% second offer
- The same model on all Meesho shipments: ₹653 Cr a year

Pricing Model: What Meesho Pays the Seller for a Refused Parcel, Worked for Four Listings



FROM MARGIN ESTIMATE TO MEESHO’S PRICE, ₹ PER REFUSED PARCEL FROM THE MOMENT OF REFUSAL

Step	Oxidised jhumkas, ₹149	Rayon kurti, ₹289	Canvas sneakers, ₹299	Kundan choker, ₹399
Closest wholesale match (image search)	₹38	₹150	₹175	₹150
Margin from wholesale: (price – wholesale – ₹47) ÷ price	43%	32%	26%	51%
Margin from seller signals	56%	41%	32%	67%
Blended margin (60% wholesale, 40% signals)	48%	36%	28%	57%
Margin band → discount Meesho asks for	High → 15%	Medium → 10%	Medium → 10%	High → 15%
Meesho pays her: price – discount – ₹47	₹80	₹213	₹222	₹292
Worth to her if it comes back (walk-away)	₹75	₹207	₹211	₹291
Shoppers a day in the pincode (category, size)	70	64	44	24
Sold in the 24 h flash sale	63%	59%	46%	29%
Meesho: send it back (today)	–₹29	–₹29	–₹29	–₹29
Meesho: buys it and resells it	+₹30	+₹29	+₹22	+₹34
Meesho if it pays 0% off (price – ₹47)	+₹8	+₹0	–₹8	–₹27

Estimating her margin

- Category norm (jewellery 50%, clothes 35%, shoes 28%), price vs similar listings, maker or reseller, deepest past discount
- Under 20% low (ask ≤10%); 20–40% medium (10%); over 40% high (15%)

Never below the seller’s walk-away

- Walk-away = price – ₹47 shipping – ₹15 repack – damage risk – ~7 weeks of money tied up at 24% a year
- Jhumkas: ₹149 – ₹62 – ₹9 – ₹3 = ₹75, so selling to Meesho for ₹80 leaves the seller better off
- If the seller declines, Meesho asks once more at 0% off, only for fast sellers (60%+ expected to sell in 24 h). Of these four, only the jhumkas qualify

If it doesn’t sell in 24 hours

- Kirana, weeks 1–2: 5–10% off, 35% a week. City, week 3: 10% off, 60%. India, weeks 4–5: 15% off, 60% a week
- Last 1–2% to bulk resellers at 35% of price

Five-Year Projection, Stress Tests and What Each Pados Point Earns



FIVE YEARS, ₹ CR (ORDERS +15% A YEAR; 20% OF VALMO PINCODES IN FY27, ALL BY FY30)

Year	Valmo pincodes live	Scale vs FY26	Net on Valmo	Same model, all Meesho
FY27	20%	0.23×	75	150
FY28	55%	0.73×	237	475
FY29	85%	1.29×	422	844
FY30	100%	1.75×	571	1,142
FY31	100%	2.01×	656	1,313
Five years			1,962	3,924

STRESS TESTS

Case, full-scale year on Valmo	₹ Cr
Base case (recovery only)	326
Flash sale sells 20%, not 40%	201
Later sales 30% slower	253
+₹4 handling per parcel unsold after 24 h	298
Only 75% of parcels resaleable	288
All four at once (combined downside)	59
No resale is a new order	58
Every seller paid at 0% off	-47
2-try cap test, if it passes (extra)	+118
Same model on all Meesho shipments	653

LOCAL SPACE NEEDED (15,000 PINCODES)

Per pincode, full rollout	Value
RTO parcels a day	36
Offered for local resale	21 a day
Wait at a kirana	13 a day
Average wait	~12 days
Waiting on each shelf (7 kiranas)	≈21 parcels
Shelf space each (8 per sq ft)	≈2.6 sq ft

WHAT A KIRANA EARNs (₹15 / ₹20 / ₹10)

Shelf	3 sq ft	5 sq ft	8 sq ft
Parcels it holds	24	40	64
Held a day	1.5	1.8	1.8
Collected a day	0.8	1.1	1.1
Same-day pickups	0.6	0.6	0.6
Earns a month	₹1,339	₹1,632	₹1,632

₹5 OFF FOR KIRANA PICKUP: DOES IT PAY?

First home attempt fails	20%	30%	40%
Home drop, up to 2 tries	₹25.8	₹28.6	₹31.6
Kirana pickup (₹10 + ₹4 stop)	₹14	₹14	₹14
Saving from pickup	₹11.8	₹14.6	₹17.6
Buyer's discount	₹5	₹5	₹5
Meesho keeps	₹6.8	₹9.6	₹12.6

What this tells us

Every stress test stays positive: all four at once still gives ₹59 Cr, and even with no new orders it is ₹58 Cr. The pilot measures new orders and flash sell-through first. Each kirana needs ~2.6 sq ft of shelf and earns ~₹1,632 a month with 5 sq ft (₹1,339 with 3). The ₹5 pickup discount pays for itself at every failure rate.

Primary and company-disclosed

- Meesho Limited investor filing: TrustMesh, RTO reduction over 10%, 166 Mn listings, 9 Mn blocked transactions, AAAI 2026 paper
- bseindia.com/xml-data/corpfiling/AttachLive/8633c34d-fa92-4bfc-8ea1-dd847555e6d9.pdf
- Business Standard: Valmo handles 50% of orders; AI fraud detection predicts RTO in real time; GeoIndia address model
- business-standard.com/companies/start-ups/meesho-s-logistics-arm-valmo-handles-50-of-orders-doubling-from-last-year-125032601337_1.html
- TechCrunch: Meesho AI and customer support; 160 Mn customers, 80% from smaller cities, towns and villages
- techcrunch.com/2024/11/26/ai-helps-indias-meesho-cut-customer-call-costs-by-75
- IndMoney: Meesho AI stack covering TrustMesh, GeoIndia LLM and last-mile error reduction
- indmoney.com/blog/stocks/meesho-ai-shift-what-investors-should-watch
- Lets Data Science: PRISM powers over 75% of orders; RTO down more than 10%
- letsdatascience.com/news/meeshos-prism-drives-over-75-of-orders-37e600bc

Case study references

- Optoro: SmartDisposition engine routes returns to restock, recommerce or reshipping to a new shopper
- optoro.com/returns-processing/
- Optoro: returns dispositioning explainer
- optoro.com/returns-blog/returns-dispositioning/
- Optoro: customer story, 91% of returns resold, net recovery up 150%
- optoro.com/customer-stories/leading-online-marketplace/
- Optoro: client list including Gap, American Eagle, Best Buy and UPS Supply Chain; over \$10bn of returned merchandise processed
- g2.com/products/optoro/discuss
- Fulfill.com: Optoro profile, clients and scale
- fulfill.com/partners/optoro
- Amazon India "I Have Space": around 28,000 kirana partners handling 30 to 40 parcels a day, running since 2014
- Cainiao Post, China: over 170,000 neighbourhood pickup stations

Industry estimates

- Published by logistics SaaS vendors and industry aggregators. Not audited or platform-reported data.
- GoKwik: RTO cause categories, pre-dispatch and post-dispatch
- gokwik.co/blog/how-to-reduce-rto-in-e-commerce
- First Resort: E-Commerce Returns and RTO in Indian Fashion 2026; attributes the 60 to 70% low-intent and 20 to 25% logistics split to GoKwik
- firstresort.in/blogs/research/fashion-ecommerce-returns-rto-india-2026
- Variant Studio: Meesho COD RTO cited at 15 to 25%; seller penalties above 25%
- variantstudio.in/blog/reduce-meesho-rto-rate-strategies-2026
- ClickPost: RTO by category, fashion 25 to 40%, electronics 10 to 15%, FMCG 8 to 12%; direct logistics cost ₹150 to 300 per RTO parcel
- Pragma: all-category RTO around 17%; COD 28 to 35% against prepaid 4 to 8%
- Unicommerce: FY23 COD returns 20.9% against prepaid 5.8%
- Shipmozo: customer not available at 35 to 40% of NDRs
- ShipSagar: NDR split, customer not available 25 to 30%, refused 15 to 20%, wrong address 20 to 25%
- GoSwift: incomplete or incorrect address around 14% of NDRs
- Caller.digital: NDR codes, wrong address 18 to 24%, refused 12 to 16%, phone unreachable 8 to 12%, fake attempt 5 to 8%
- Shipway ShipNotes FY25: around 26% RTO on COD against under 2% prepaid
- Razorpay Thirdwatch and KaratCart: AI scores COD orders on 200+ parameters; RTO down 10% in month one, 21% in month two, 36% in month three
- AllianceBernstein: apparel and fashion around 50% of Meesho GMV
- Flipkart Internet FY22 filings: transportation cost ₹5,045 Cr on revenue ₹10,659 Cr
- Warehouse rent benchmarks: Tier 2 and 3 India ₹8 to 25 per sq ft per month; Bengaluru Grade B ₹18 to 30; Delhi NCR Grade B ₹20 to 35, plus ₹2 to 2.5 for maintenance, power and security

Own primary research

- Customer survey: 64 responses across around 16 Indian states and union territories. Sample skews urban and prepaid-heavy relative to Meesho's base.
- Delivery agent interviews: 9 agents
- Seller interviews: 6 sellers, 3 on text and 3 on call, across jewellery, clothes and shoes. Screenshots retained with consent.
- Case pack: DICE Challenge S3 Valmo case study. COD 80%, RTO 20% and 5%, forward ₹50, reverse ₹120, node split 4/2/5/8/5/5/21, distance 15%, 17% and 22%.